PHAEMA user manual

Nov 10, 2026 · @Stuart

1. About this manual

This manual explains how to use PHAEMA (Property Holding and Estate Management Application) for every part of a council's commercial and operational estate: the property register, leases and key dates, casework, rents and service charges, maintenance and compliance, and asset valuation. It is written for everyone who uses PHAEMA, from surveyors and finance officers to administrators.

The same text is inside PHAEMA: select **Help** in the menu, or **Help with this page** near the top of any page. Interactive training for each role is under **Help**, **Training courses**.

How it is organised. Sections 2 and 3 cover getting around. Sections 4 to 13 follow the work, one area at a time. Section 14 covers reports and data, section 15 administration, and section 16 lists common tasks by role.

Examples. Screenshots and worked examples use the fictional demonstration data for two districts, Exampleton (references DM-E and DM-S) and Northfield (DM-N). Every name, address and number in them is invented.

Optional modules. The rent ledger, service charges, maintenance, compliance and asset valuation can each be switched on or off by an administrator. If you cannot see a section described here, it is probably switched off.

Words you may not know, such as WAULT, UPRN or "contracted out", are in the glossary at the end.

2. Getting started

Signing in

Use the username and password your PHAEMA administrator gave you. If you can sign in but see a page saying you do not have access, you have not been given a role yet: ask an administrator.

You can type your **email address** in place of your username. This works when the address belongs to one account only.

Two-step sign-in. If your council asks for it, PHAEMA wants a 6-digit code from an authenticator app on your phone after your password. Select **Two-step sign-in** in the menu to set it up: scan the code shown with the app, enter the first 6-digit code, and keep the single-use recovery codes somewhere safe in case you lose the phone. Administrators are asked to set it up by default; your council can require it for everyone.

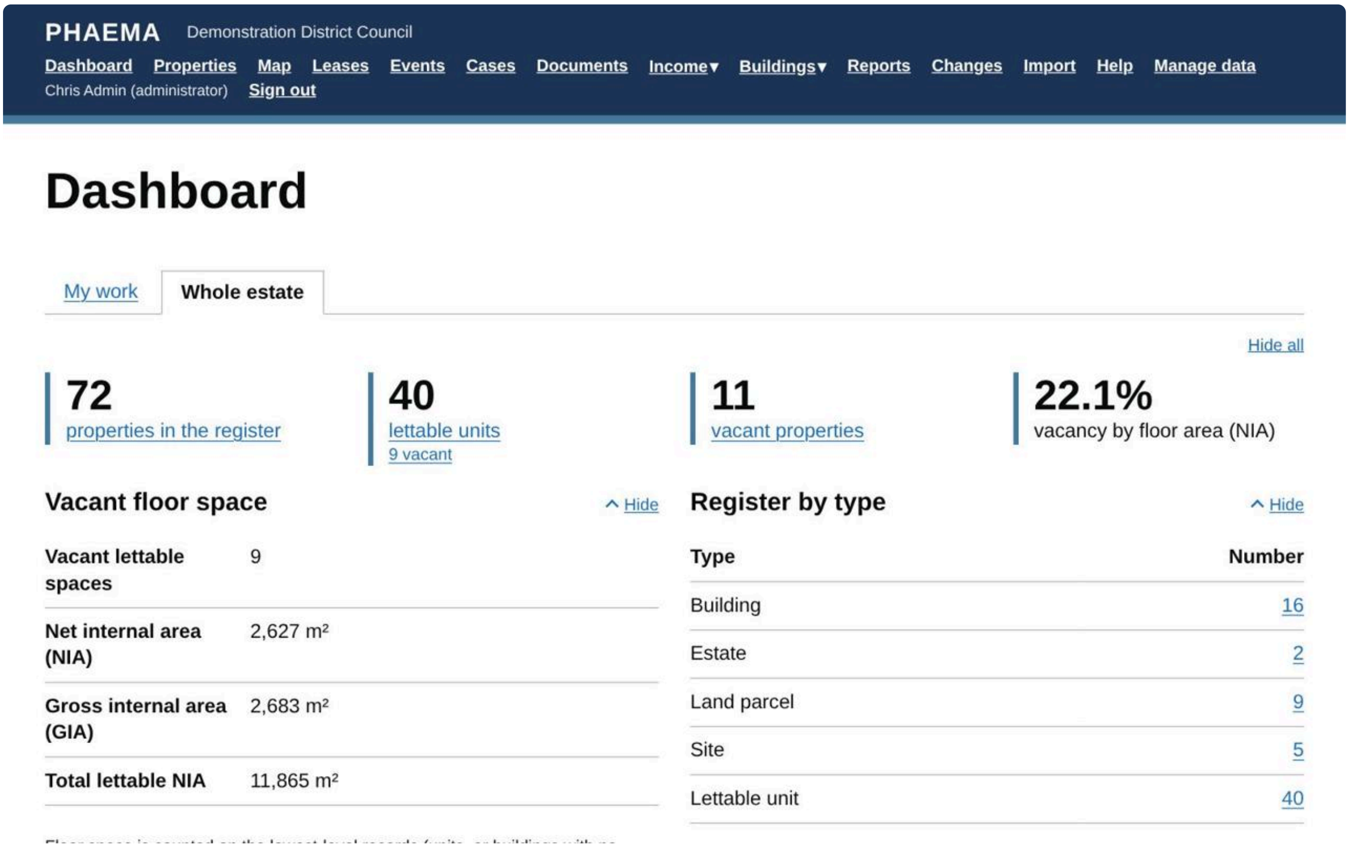
Changing your password. Select **Change password** in the menu. Passwords need at least 12 characters.

Forgotten your password. Select **Forgotten your password?** on the sign-in page and enter your email address or username. PHAEMA emails you a link to choose a new password. The link works once and for one hour, and your old password keeps working until you use it. If you use two-step sign-in, you are still asked for your code when you next sign in. If no email arrives, look in your junk folder, check you typed the address or username your sign-in uses, then ask an administrator.

Signing in with your council account. If your council has turned on single sign-on, the sign-in page has a **Sign in with Microsoft** button (the name may differ). Select it and sign in as you do for email. Your council's own password and security checks apply, so PHAEMA does not ask for a two-step code as well. People outside the council, such as consultants, valuers and solicitors, either sign in below the button with a PHAEMA password, or use the button if the council has given them a guest account.

Trying PHAEMA on the test site. You can follow this manual on the public test site at demo.phaema.co.uk, which holds the same fictional demonstration data as the examples here. To get a sign-in, select **Request a test account** on the site and give your name and email address; you will be emailed when your account is ready. Everything on the test site is reset every 48 hours, so do not enter real or personal information.

The menu


PHAEMA
Demonstration District Council
Dashboard
Properties
Map
Leases
Events
Cases
Documents
Income▾
Buildings▾
Reports
Changes
Import
Help
Manage data
Chris Admin (administrator)
Sign out
My work
Whole estate
Hide all
^ Hide
^ Hide

Dashboard

72 properties in the register

40 lettable units
9 vacant

11 vacant properties

22.1% vacancy by floor area (NIA)

Vacant floor space

Vacant lettable spaces	9
Net internal area (NIA)	2,627 m²
Gross internal area (GIA)	2,683 m²
Total lettable NIA	11,865 m²

Register by type

Type	Number
Building	16
Estate	2
Land parcel	9
Site	5
Lettable unit	40

The menu at the top of every page takes you to each area.

Menu item	What it is for
Dashboard	Your own work (My work) and the figures for the whole estate
Properties	The property register
Map	Every property with a location
Leases	Leases and licences, and the parties to them
Events	Key dates: rent reviews, breaks, expiries
Cases	Consents, requests and other work from start to outcome
Projects	Developments, acquisitions, disposals and programmes, taken through gateways (section 7)
Documents	Letters and notices filled in from PHAEMA, downloaded to Word
Income	Rents, arrears and service charges, when switched on

Menu item	What it is for
Buildings	Maintenance, compliance and asset valuation, when switched on
Reports	Ready-made and your own reports
Changes	The change log: who changed what, and when
Import	Administrators only: import from spreadsheets
Manage data	Administrators and surveyors: add and edit records and settings
Hand over work	Administrators only: move someone's properties, cases and tasks to colleagues
Help	This manual and the training courses

Finding records

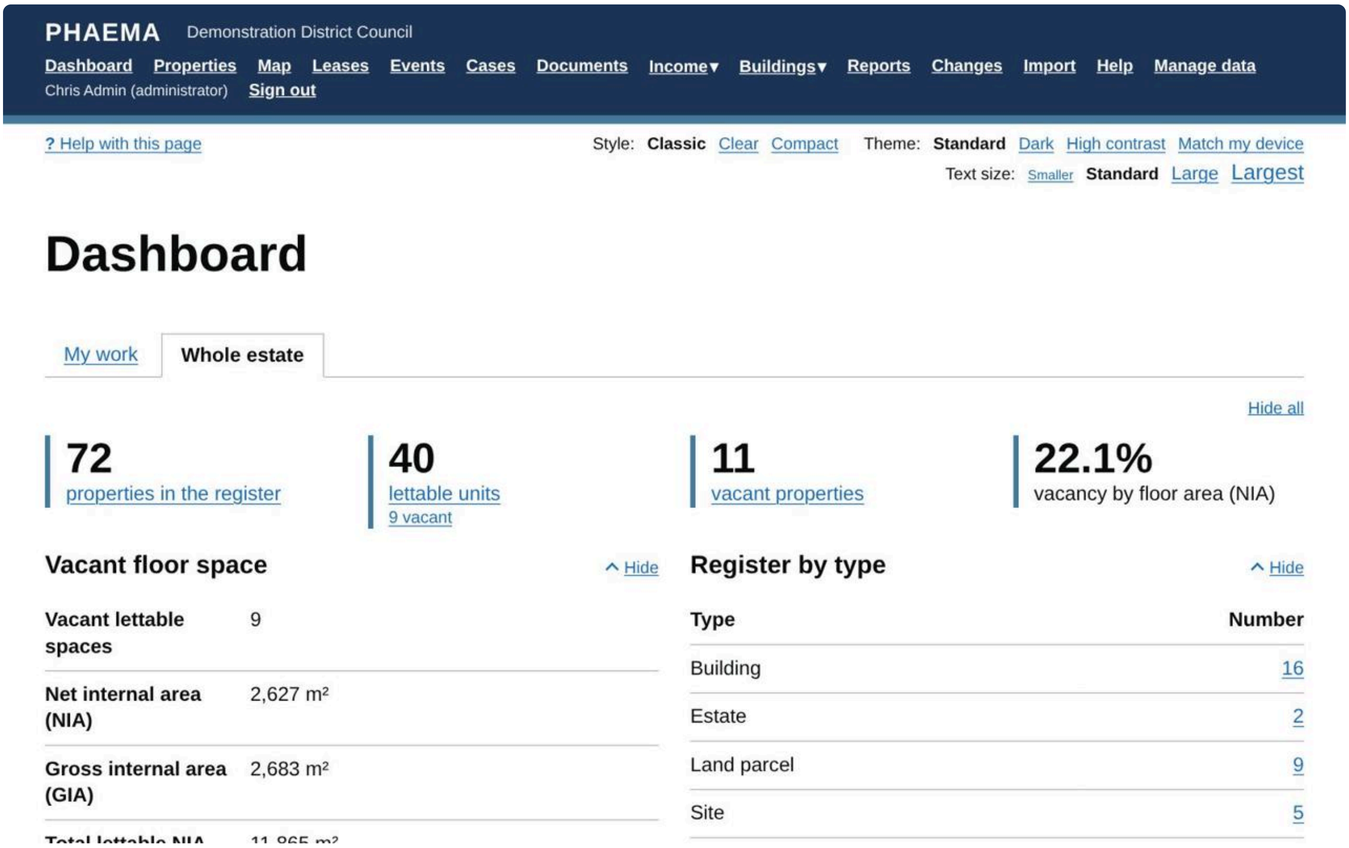
Every list has filters and a search box. Choose your filters and select **Apply**. Select a column heading to sort by it; select it again to reverse the order. Many lists can also be filtered by **building or estate** (including everything within it) and by **managing surveyor**.

Every list has **Download Excel** and **Download CSV** links, which download exactly what you are looking at, with your filters and order.

Adding and changing records

Use the **Edit** link on a record's page, or **Manage data**. Whether you can change a record depends on your role. Every change is recorded in the change log.

Making PHAEMA easier to read


PHAEMA
Demonstration District Council
Dashboard Properties Map Leases Events Cases Documents Income▾ Buildings▾ Reports Changes Import Help Manage data
Chris Admin (administrator) Sign out
? Help with this page
Style: Classic Clear Compact
Theme: Standard Dark High contrast Match my device
Text size: Smaller Standard Large Largest
My work
Whole estate
Hide all
Hide
Hide

Dashboard

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Under the menu are three settings that PHAEMA remembers on your computer:

- **Style**: Classic (the GOV.UK look), Clear (boxed sections with an easy-to-read typeface) or Compact (more on screen).
- **Theme**: Standard, Dark, High contrast (yellow on black), or Match my device.
- **Text size**: Smaller to Largest. Browser zoom also works.

PHAEMA is designed to meet the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.2 at level AA. Every page works with a keyboard alone and with screen readers.

Roles at a glance

Role	Can
Administrator	Everything, including settings, imports, users and accepting valuations
Surveyor	Work on cases and change the properties, leases and events they manage
Contributor	Add notes, emails and documents to cases they are added to

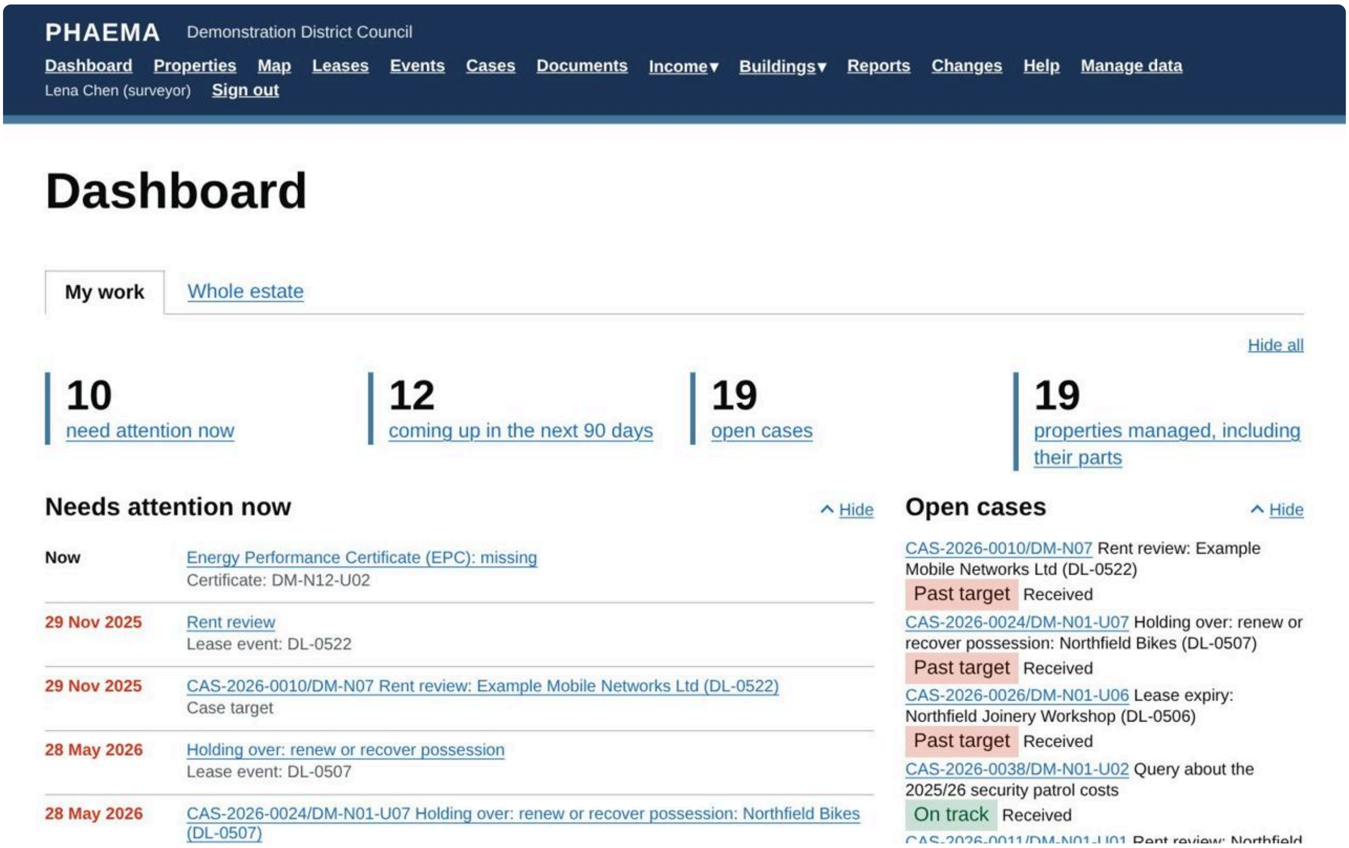
Role	Can
Viewer	See the core of PHAEMA and the modules their access areas open, run reports and download lists

Which optional modules each person can open (rent ledger, service charges, maintenance, compliance, asset valuation) depends on their access areas, described in section 15.

3. Dashboards

The dashboard is the first page after signing in, and everything on it links to the records behind it. It has two tabs, **My work** and **Whole estate.** Surveyors start on My work and everyone else on Whole estate; PHAEMA then remembers the tab you last chose.

My work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Help
Manage data
Lena Chen (surveyor)
Sign out

Dashboard

My work
Whole estate
Hide all

10 need attention now

12 coming up in the next 90 days

19 open cases

19 properties managed, including their parts

Needs attention now

^ Hide

Now	Energy Performance Certificate (EPC): missing Certificate: DM-N12-U02
29 Nov 2025	Rent review Lease event: DL-0522
29 Nov 2025	CAS-2026-0010/DM-N07 Rent review: Example Mobile Networks Ltd (DL-0522) Case target
28 May 2026	Holding over: renew or recover possession Lease event: DL-0507
28 May 2026	CAS-2026-0024/DM-N01-U07 Holding over: renew or recover possession: Northfield Bikes (DL-0507)

Open cases

CAS-2026-0010/DM-N07 Rent review: Example Mobile Networks Ltd (DL-0522)
Past target Received

CAS-2026-0024/DM-N01-U07 Holding over: renew or recover possession: Northfield Bikes (DL-0507)
Past target Received

CAS-2026-0026/DM-N01-U06 Lease expiry: Northfield Joinery Workshop (DL-0506)
Past target Received

CAS-2026-0038/DM-N01-U02 Query about the 2025/26 security patrol costs
On track Received

CAS-2026-0011/DM-N01-U01 Rent review: Northfield

- **Needs attention now**: anything overdue or waiting for you, oldest first. It covers your lease events (and unassigned events on your properties), cases past target, overdue case tasks, approvals waiting for you, repairs past target and overdue planned maintenance on your properties, missing or expired certificates, and audit queries to answer.

- **Coming up in the next 90 days**: the same things falling due soon, plus certificates expiring and valuations assigned to you.
- **Open cases** you own, with how each is doing against its target.
- **Properties managed**: the properties you manage, with their parts, live lettings and rent. A surveyor who manages an estate or building also manages everything within it.
- **My projects**: projects you lead or are on the team of. Your overdue project tasks and missed milestones appear under Needs attention now.
- **Compliance**, **rent arrears** and **open repairs** on your properties, when those modules are on.

Supervisors can choose someone they supervise under **Show the work of**, for example to cover absence or for one-to-ones. Administrators can see anyone's.

Whole estate

- **Headline figures**: properties in the register, lettable units, vacant properties and vacancy by floor area.
- **Vacant floor space**: vacant net and gross internal areas. Floor space is counted on the lowest-level records only, so a building and its units are never counted twice.
- **Cases**, **maintenance** and **compliance** at a glance, with anything waiting for your approval.
- **Lease events**: open events by type, split into overdue and the next six months.
- **Rent roll**: rent from current agreements by holding purpose, and the WAULT to expiry and to first break. With the rent ledger on, it also shows arrears and the collection rate over 12 months.
- **Recent changes**: the latest edits, with who made them.

The **Lease events** panel also shows:

- **Tenancies at will in place**, highlighted because they are meant to be short-term. Select the number to list them.
- **Lease expiries** split into **contracted in** (the tenant has 1954 Act protection) and **contracted out**. A third line appears only when some agreements are marked not applicable or not known.
- **Lease documents to review**: documents whose date for review has passed or falls in the next 6 months.
- **Time is of the essence**: open rent reviews on agreements carrying that flag, in red, with how many are past the review date.

Hiding sections

Each section has a **Hide** link in its heading; **Hide all** and **Show all** do every section at once. PHAEMA remembers what you hide on that computer, and hidden sections still print.

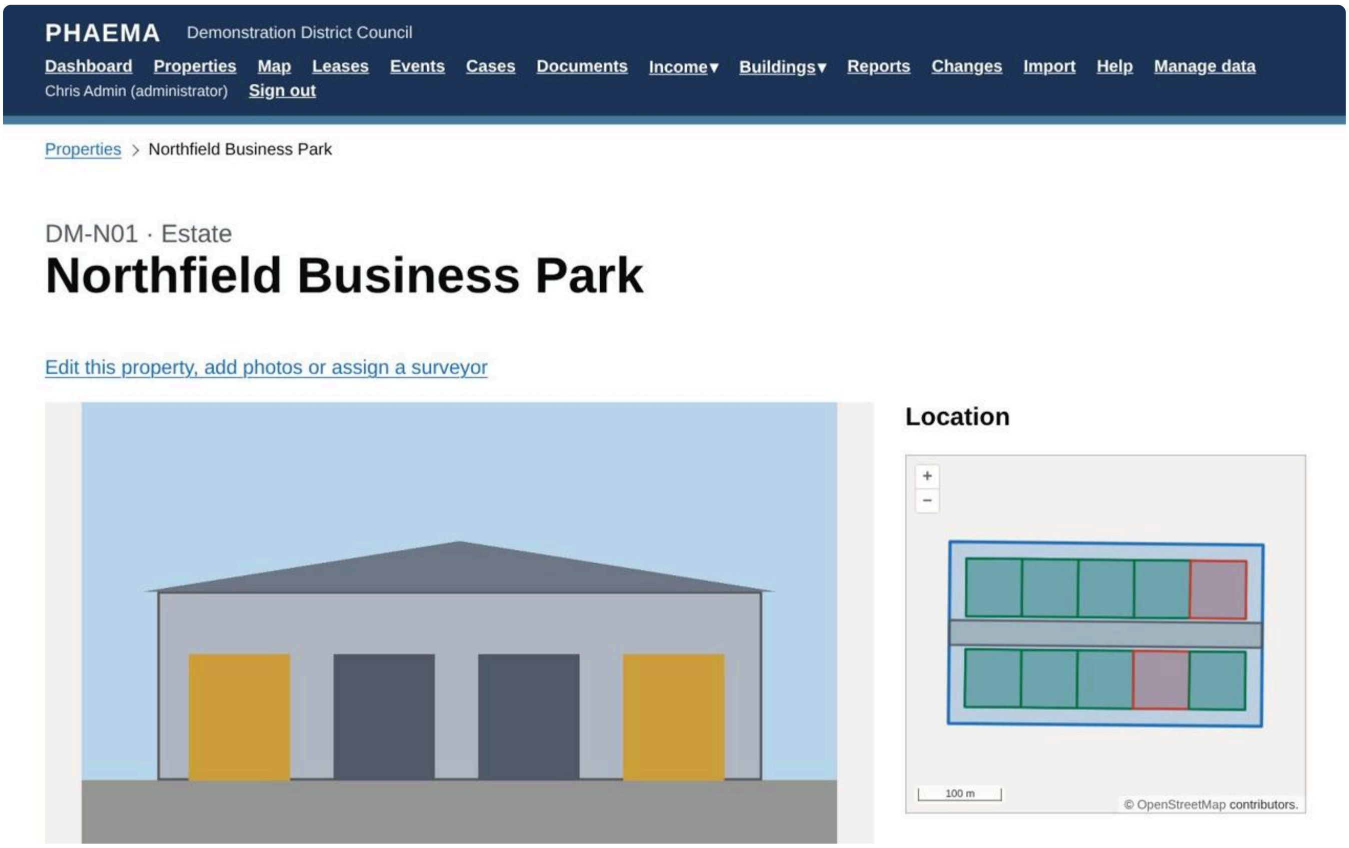
4. Properties, maps and parties

The property register holds every property the council owns, leases or manages, except housing stock.

How properties fit together

Properties form a hierarchy, and each can be **part of** another:

- **Estate**: a group of sites managed together, such as an industrial estate.
- **Site**: one piece of land, which can hold buildings.
- **Building**: a building on a site.
- **Lettable unit**: a part of a building that can be let, such as a shop or office suite.
- **Land parcel**: land without buildings, such as a field or car park.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Buildings▾
Reports
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Help
Manage data
Chris Admin (administrator)
Sign out
Properties > Northfield Business Park
+
−
100 m
© OpenStreetMap contributors.

DM-N01 · Estate

Northfield Business Park

Edit this property, add photos or assign a surveyor

Location

Key facts

Field	Meaning
Reference	The council's unique asset reference
UPRN and USRN	National property and street reference numbers, linking PHAEMA to GIS, council tax and business rates
Holding purpose	Operational, investment, community, surplus, or held for disposal
Tenure	Freehold, leasehold, other, or none (managed but not owned)
Occupation	Council, let, partly let, vacant, or not applicable
Managing surveyor	The surveyor responsible. Events on the property's leases are assigned to them
Exclude from open data	For sensitive properties, left out of any published list
Disposed of, disposal price	When the council sold or transferred it, and for how much. The property stays for its history but leaves open data. Usually recorded from a disposal project's completion checklist.
Site hazards	What anyone visiting should know first. Shown on cases, jobs and valuations for the property and everything within it

Three more facts classify a property for the council's own reporting:

Fact	What it records
Portfolio	The service or portfolio that holds the property, such as Investment, Leisure, Children's Services or Adult Social Care. Administrators keep the list under **Manage data**, **Portfolios**.
Estate strategy section	The section of the council's estate strategy or asset management plan that covers the property. Blank until the council fills it in.
Holding purpose review date	When the reason for holding the property is next due for review.

The register can be filtered by portfolio and by holding purpose reviews that are overdue or due in the next 12 months. All three are columns in reports and in the import template.

Floor areas

PHAEMA records gross internal area (GIA) and net internal area (NIA) in square metres, and site area in hectares. The property page shows the GIA and NIA of the buildings within, the lettable NIA, the non-lettable area and the net-to-gross ratio. Record how areas were measured (RICS Code of Measuring Practice or IPMS), the source (survey, drawings, lease plan or estimate) and the date. The report **Floor areas with no measurement basis** lists properties still to check.

Site and buildings

The **Site and buildings** section of a property's page describes what is physically there, so that whoever manages or values it can understand it without a visit. Fill it in from **Edit this property**, under **Site and buildings** and **Services**. Leave blank anything you do not know: blanks are not shown.

What	Notes
Location	Where the property is and what surrounds it: the part of town, road links, neighbouring uses, access
Site area	In hectares or square metres. Type either one and PHAEMA works out the other
Description	For a site, the buildings and land. For a building, its layout and accommodation
Built	A year or a period, such as 1987 or 1930s

What	Notes
Construction	Chosen from a list, with a line of detail such as "cavity brick walls, solid concrete floors"
Storeys	Above ground, with basement levels counted separately
Roof type and covering	Each chosen from a list, with a line of detail for mixed roofs or the date of re-covering
Windows	Chosen from a list, with a line of detail
Parking	A description and the number of spaces
Services	Mains gas, electricity (three-phase or single-phase), mains water and drainage, with notes for heating, capacity or meters
Solar panels	Yes or no, and the capacity in kWp

Sites with several blocks. Record the site as a whole (location, site area, parking) on the site or estate, and the construction, storeys, roof, windows and services on each building within it.

Floor plans. In **Edit this property**, under **Floor plans**, add each plan with a title such as "Ground floor plan". Plans can be PDFs or AutoCAD drawings (.dwg or .dxf), up to 50 MB each. PDFs open in the browser; AutoCAD drawings download to open in your drawing software. Surveyors can add plans to the properties they manage.

Adding plans and photos by dragging. On the property's page, open **Add floor plans or photos** and drag the files onto the box for plans or the box for photos, or choose them: up to 20 at a time. Each plan is titled, and each photo captioned, with its file name; change these, or remove one, in **Edit this property**.

All of these can be chosen as columns and filters in reports, and filled in from a spreadsheet with the property import.

The property report

Property report on a property's page gathers everything PHAEMA holds about it into one document: the key facts, location, description, construction and services (with each building in turn), floor areas and how they are made up, floor plans, titles, current tenancies and other agreements with their main terms, and the cases in hand. It ends with a list of what a valuer is likely to ask for that has not been recorded yet. Read it on screen, print it, or select **Download as Word** to edit and send. On an asset valuation case the same report is headed **Initial valuation report** (section 13).

Photos and titles

Add photos in **Edit this property**: they are resized and their location data removed. Land Registry titles are linked to properties and can hold the register and plan as PDFs; administrators manage them.

The map

Select **Map** to see every property with a boundary or a grid reference, coloured by occupation. Filters work as on the property list. OpenStreetMap is always available; Ordnance Survey maps appear when an administrator adds the council's OS Maps API key. Administrators can import HM Land Registry INSPIRE Index Polygons, and anyone who can change a property can **set its boundary** from those parcels. INSPIRE boundaries show the general extent of a title, not its legal boundary.

Parties

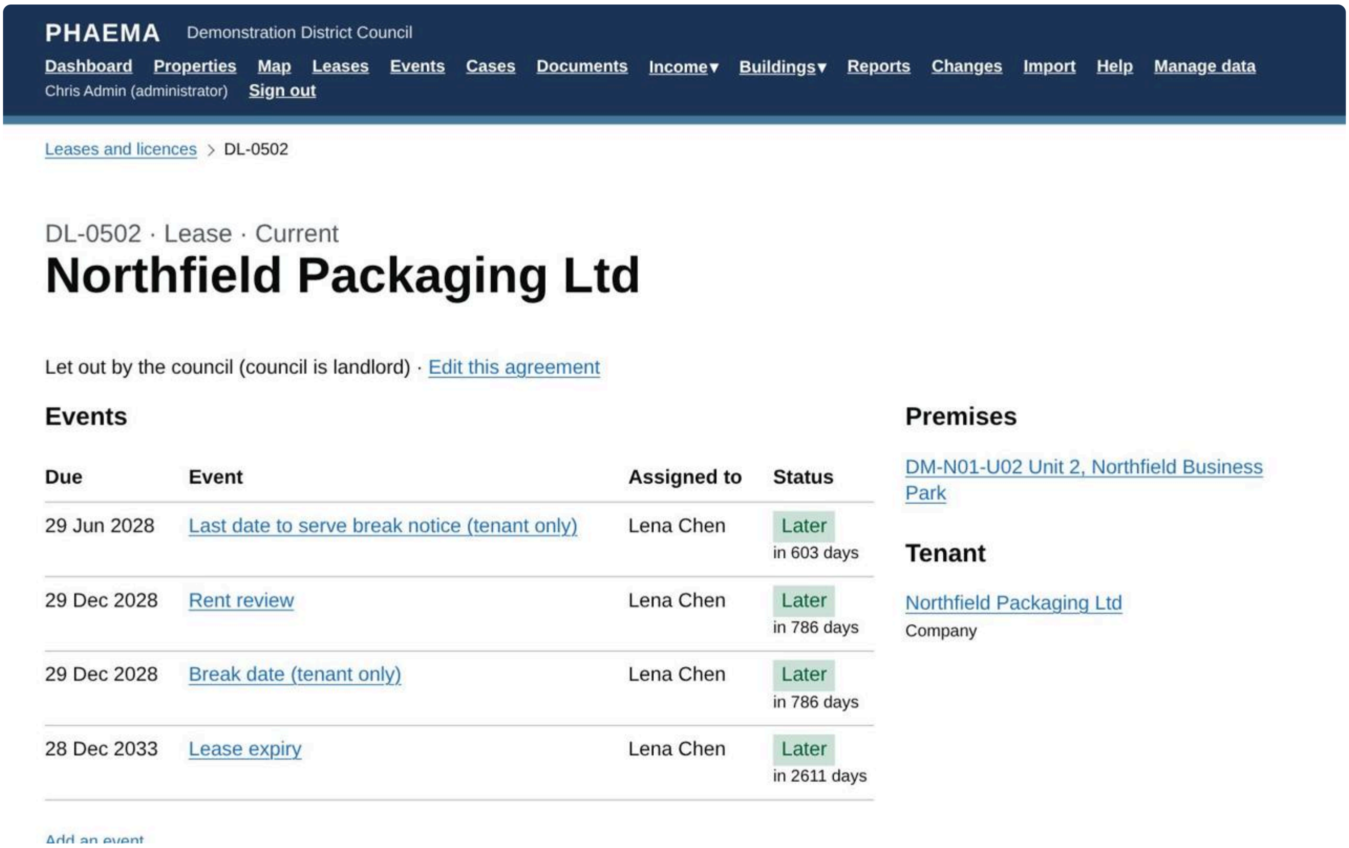
A party is anyone the council has an agreement with: tenant, landlord, licensee or guarantor. Each is recorded once and linked to all their agreements. A party's page shows contact details, company or charity number, every agreement and property, and the total rent. Record the **finance customer reference** to link the party to the finance system.

Worked example

DM-N01 Northfield Business Park is an estate. Its parts are the Hangar block (units 1 to 5), the Workshop block (units 6 to 10) and the estate roads. Units 4 and 10 are vacant, so the estate shows as partly let. Lena Chen manages DM-N01, so she also manages every block and unit within it. **DM-N06 Former Northfield bus depot** has no managing surveyor (filter the register by **Managing surveyor: Nobody**) and records site hazards, which appear on every case, job and valuation for it.

5. Leases, rents and key dates

PHAEMA records every agreement over council property, let out by the council (it receives rent) or held by it (it pays rent): leases, licences, tenancies at will, agreements for lease, farm business tenancies, wayleaves, easements and concessions.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Chris Admin (administrator)
Sign out
Leases and licences > DL-0502
Add an event

DL-0502 · Lease · Current

Northfield Packaging Ltd

Let out by the council (council is landlord) · Edit this agreement

Events

Due	Event	Assigned to	Status
29 Jun 2028	Last date to serve break notice (tenant only)	Lena Chen	Later in 603 days
29 Dec 2028	Rent review	Lena Chen	Later in 786 days
29 Dec 2028	Break date (tenant only)	Lena Chen	Later in 786 days
28 Dec 2033	Lease expiry	Lena Chen	Later in 2611 days

Premises

DM-N01-U02 Unit 2, Northfield Business Park

Tenant

Northfield Packaging Ltd
Company

Adding an agreement

Select **Add a lease or licence** on the lease list. You need a unique reference, the tenant or landlord (a party), any guarantor, the premises (one or more properties), the term start and, unless it is periodic, the term end. To add many at once, import them.

Terms

Field	Notes
Status	Proposed (heads of terms), Current, Holding over or Ended
Security of tenure	Inside the Landlord and Tenant Act 1954, Part II, or contracted out
Rent and frequency	The current rent comes from the rent schedule
Review basis and interval	The next review date creates a rent review event
Repairing and insurance	Who repairs and insures; used to work out who pays for repairs
Service charge payable	Whether a service charge is due
Deposit	Amount, where held and who gets the interest

Field	Notes
Alterations, use, alienation, special rights	As the lease says

Four more settings in **Edit this agreement** flag how the agreement is managed:

Setting	What it does
Time is of the essence	Tick it in the rent review section if the lease makes time of the essence, so a missed date in the review timetable can lose the review. The review is flagged in red on the dashboard, the events list, the event page and My work.
Rent demands on hold	Stops demand runs raising rent or service charge on the agreement, with the reason. See the rent ledger section.
Arrears passed to	Records that the debt has gone to external debt collectors or to legal, with the date and their reference.
Billing contact	Who rent demands go to. Leave it blank to use the tenant's main contact; fill in only the details that differ, such as an accounts email.

Add **break options** with the break date, who can exercise it and the notice period: PHAEMA works out the last date to serve notice and creates events for both. Store the signed lease and other documents under **Documents**.

Documents and dates for review

Any lease document can carry a **date for review**: when it should next be looked at. Use it for an insurance certificate's expiry, a schedule of condition to re-inspect or a side letter that runs out. Documents coming due are counted on the dashboard, and **Events**, **Documents to review** lists them, soonest first, with a download. **Lease documents** is also a record type in reports.

Where the **tenant insures**, the agreement page shows the latest insurance certificate held, or a warning that there is none. Select **Start a case to get the tenant's insurance certificate**: the case has tasks to ask for the certificate, check the cover and add it to the agreement's documents with its expiry as the date for review.

The rent schedule

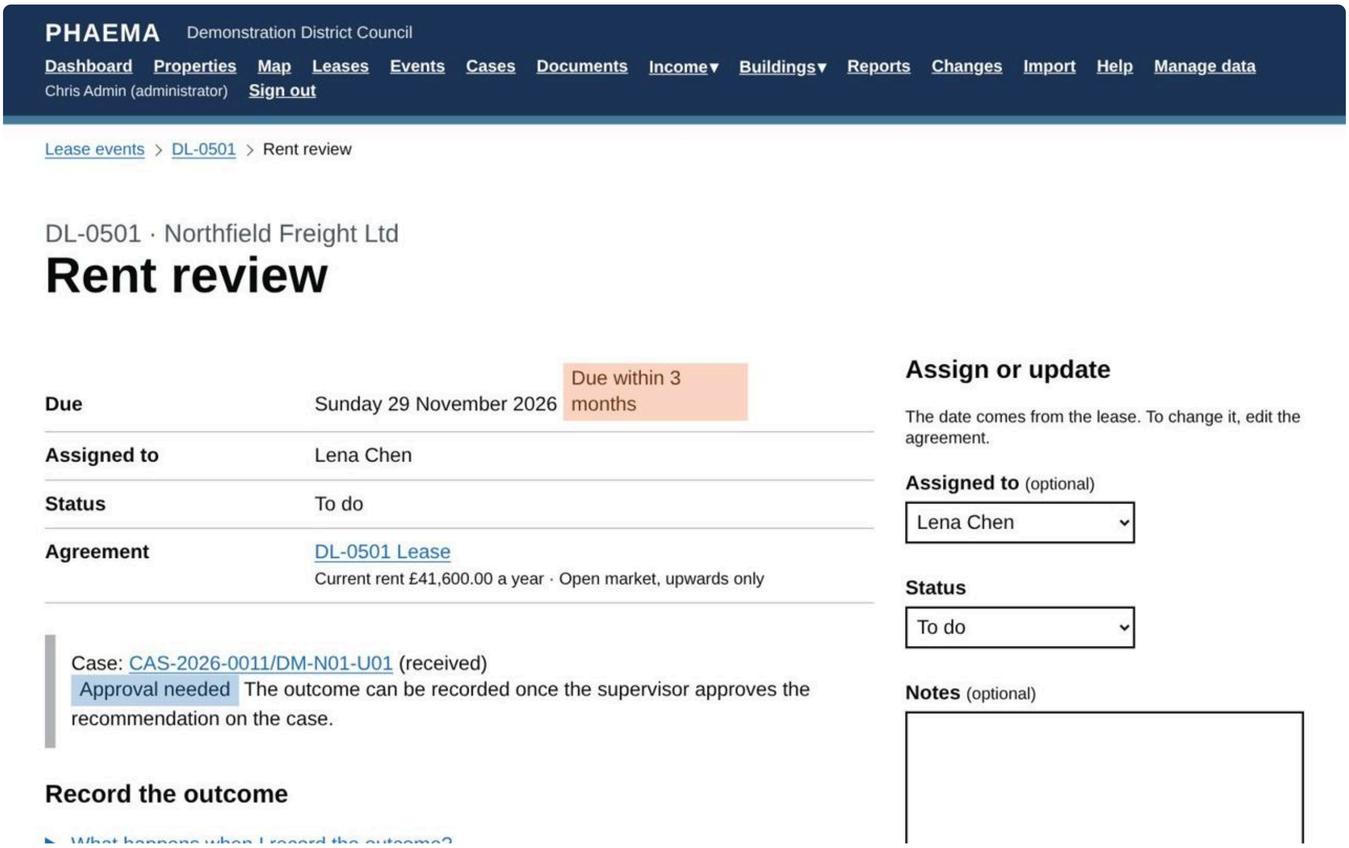
Each agreement has a list of rents, each with the date it takes effect; the current rent is always the latest one in force, so stepped rents change on the right day. Rent reviews add entries when you record the outcome. Add fixed steps, index-linked increases, concessions or variations with **Add a rent step, concession or variation**. Change rents here, never by editing the agreement or importing, so the history is kept.

Lease events

An event is a key date someone must act on. PHAEMA creates rent reviews, break notice deadlines, break dates and expiries from the agreement, and keeps them up to date. Add others with **Add an event**. Events are assigned to the managing surveyor of the premises.

Colour	Meaning
Red	Overdue: the date has passed with no outcome
Orange	Due within 3 months
Yellow	Due within 6 months
Green	Later
Grey	Completed or lapsed

Rent reviews and lease expiries (renewals) have an **estimated rental value**: the surveyor's view of the market rent. Enter it under **Assign or update** on the event. The event shows how far it is above or below the current rent, and it is a column in the events and leases reports.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Chris Admin (administrator)
Sign out
Lease events > DL-0501 > Rent review

DL-0501 · Northfield Freight Ltd

Rent review

Due	Sunday 29 November 2026 Due within 3 months
Assigned to	Lena Chen
Status	To do
Agreement	DL-0501 Lease Current rent £41,600.00 a year · Open market, upwards only

Case: CAS-2026-0011/DM-N01-U01 (received)
Approval needed The outcome can be recorded once the supervisor approves the recommendation on the case.

Record the outcome

Assign or update

The date comes from the lease. To change it, edit the agreement.

Assigned to (optional): Lena Chen

Status: To do

Notes (optional)

Recording the outcome

Open the event and select **Record the outcome**.

- **Rent review**: enter the new rent, its date and the next review date. The rent schedule and the next review are updated.
- **Break notice deadline**: *Break notice served* keeps the break date open; *No notice served* closes both.
- **Break date**: *Break exercised* ends the agreement; *Not exercised* closes the event.
- **Expiry**: *Tenant vacated*, *Renewed* or *Tenant holding over*.

Break dates and notice deadlines that pass without an outcome lapse automatically. If the event's case needs approval, the outcome waits until the supervisor approves.

Reminders and your calendar

PHAEMA emails each person a digest of their upcoming events (by default 180, 90 and 30 days before a rent review, and 365, 180 and 90 days before an expiry), and every Monday a list of anything overdue. Under **Events**, **Calendar**, you get a private address to subscribe to in Outlook or another calendar app.

Worked example

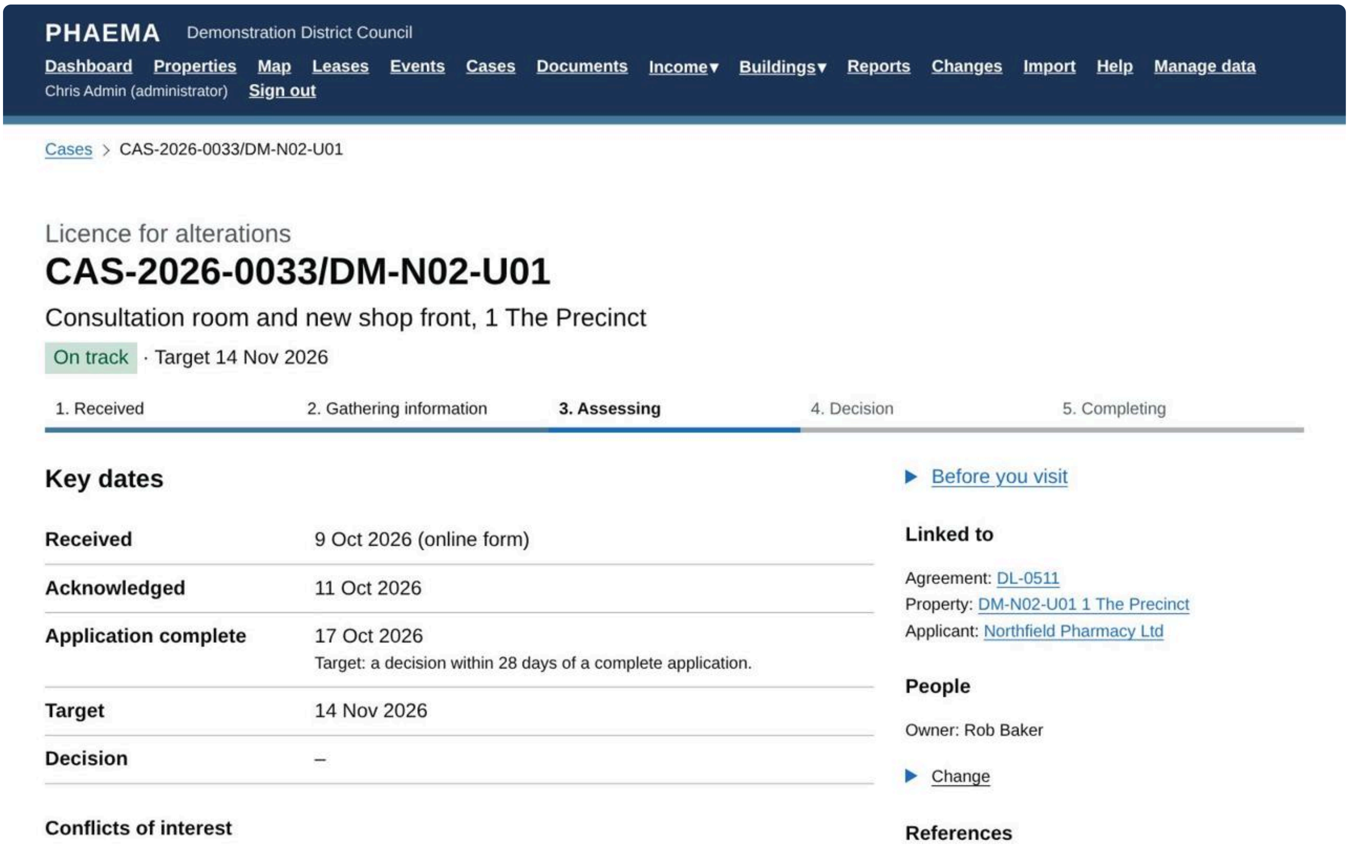
DL-0502 is Northfield Packaging Ltd's lease of Unit 2: ten years inside the 1954 Act, £39,000 a year plus VAT, reviewed upwards only every five years, full repairing with a service charge, and a £9,750 deposit in the council's deposit account. The tenant can break at year five on six months' notice, so PHAEMA has created a break notice deadline six months before the break date. If no notice arrives by the deadline, Lena Chen records *No notice served* and the lease runs on. **DL-0530** is the other way round: the council holds the Northfield Innovation Hub at £38,000 a year.

6. Cases and approvals

A case is a piece of estate work with an owner, stages, tasks and an outcome: a consent to assign, a licence for alterations, a rent review, a dilapidations claim, a request to film on council land. Each has a reference such as **CAS-2026-0042/DM-E01-U04**: the year, a number and the main property.

Where cases come from

- **Lease events** open cases by themselves ahead of the date: nine months for reviews and break notices, twelve for expiries. You can also select **Start a case for this event**.
- **Requests and other work**: **Cases**, **Start a case**, or **Start a case** on an agreement or property. Choose the type, link the agreement or property, and record how and when it arrived.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Cases
CAS-2026-0033/DM-N02-U01

Licence for alterations

CAS-2026-0033/DM-N02-U01

Consultation room and new shop front, 1 The Precinct

On track · Target 14 Nov 2026

1. Received · 2. Gathering information · **3. Assessing** · 4. Decision · 5. Completing

Key dates

Received	9 Oct 2026 (online form)
Acknowledged	11 Oct 2026
Application complete	17 Oct 2026 Target: a decision within 28 days of a complete application.
Target	14 Nov 2026
Decision	–

Conflicts of interest

▶ Before you visit

Linked to

Agreement: DL-0511
Property: DM-N02-U01 1 The Precinct
Applicant: Northfield Pharmacy Ltd

People

Owner: Rob Baker

▶ Change

References

Stages and tasks

Every case moves through **Received**, **Gathering information**, **Assessing**, **Decision** and **Completing**. Select **Move to next stage** as the work progresses. A case can be put on hold with a reason, and closed cases can be reopened. Each case type has a task list for each stage; tick tasks off and add your own.

Dates and targets

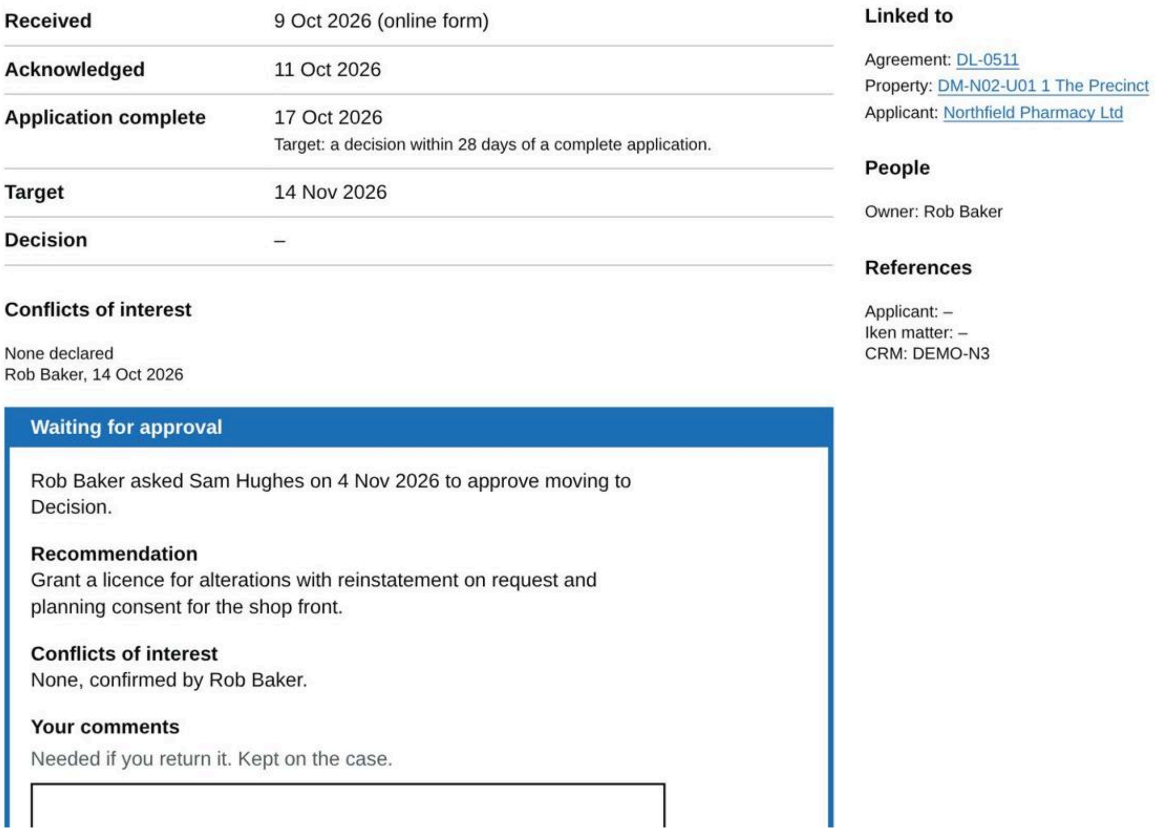
Date	What it is
Received	When the request arrived; for consents, the written application
Acknowledged	Due within 10 working days by default
Application complete	When everything needed to decide has arrived; the target counts from here
Target	28 days after a complete application for consents; for event cases, the event's date
Decision sent	When the decision letter went

For consents to assign, underlet, charge or share, the Landlord and Tenant Act 1988 requires a written decision within a reasonable time, with reasons for conditions or refusal. PHAEMA will not save conditions or a refusal without reasons, and the report **Consent decisions: time to decision** gives the evidence.

Approvals

Every surveyor has a supervisor who approves their recommendations. Most case types need approval before **Decision**. When a case reaches that point, **Move to next stage** becomes **Ask for approval**:

1. Confirm **Conflicts of interest**: no conflict, or declare one and how it is managed.
2. Write your recommendation and select **Ask** *your supervisor* **for approval**.
3. Your supervisor is emailed and sees it on their dashboard. They **Approve**, or **Return with comments** for you to revise.



Received	9 Oct 2026 (online form)
Acknowledged	11 Oct 2026
Application complete	17 Oct 2026 Target: a decision within 28 days of a complete application.
Target	14 Nov 2026
Decision	–

Conflicts of interest

None declared
Rob Baker, 14 Oct 2026

Waiting for approval

Rob Baker asked Sam Hughes on 4 Nov 2026 to approve moving to Decision.

Recommendation
Grant a licence for alterations with reinstatement on request and planning consent for the shop front.

Conflicts of interest
None, confirmed by Rob Baker.

Your comments
Needed if you return it. Kept on the case.

Linked to

Agreement: DL-0511
Property: DM-N02-U01 1 The Precinct
Applicant: Northfield Pharmacy Ltd

People

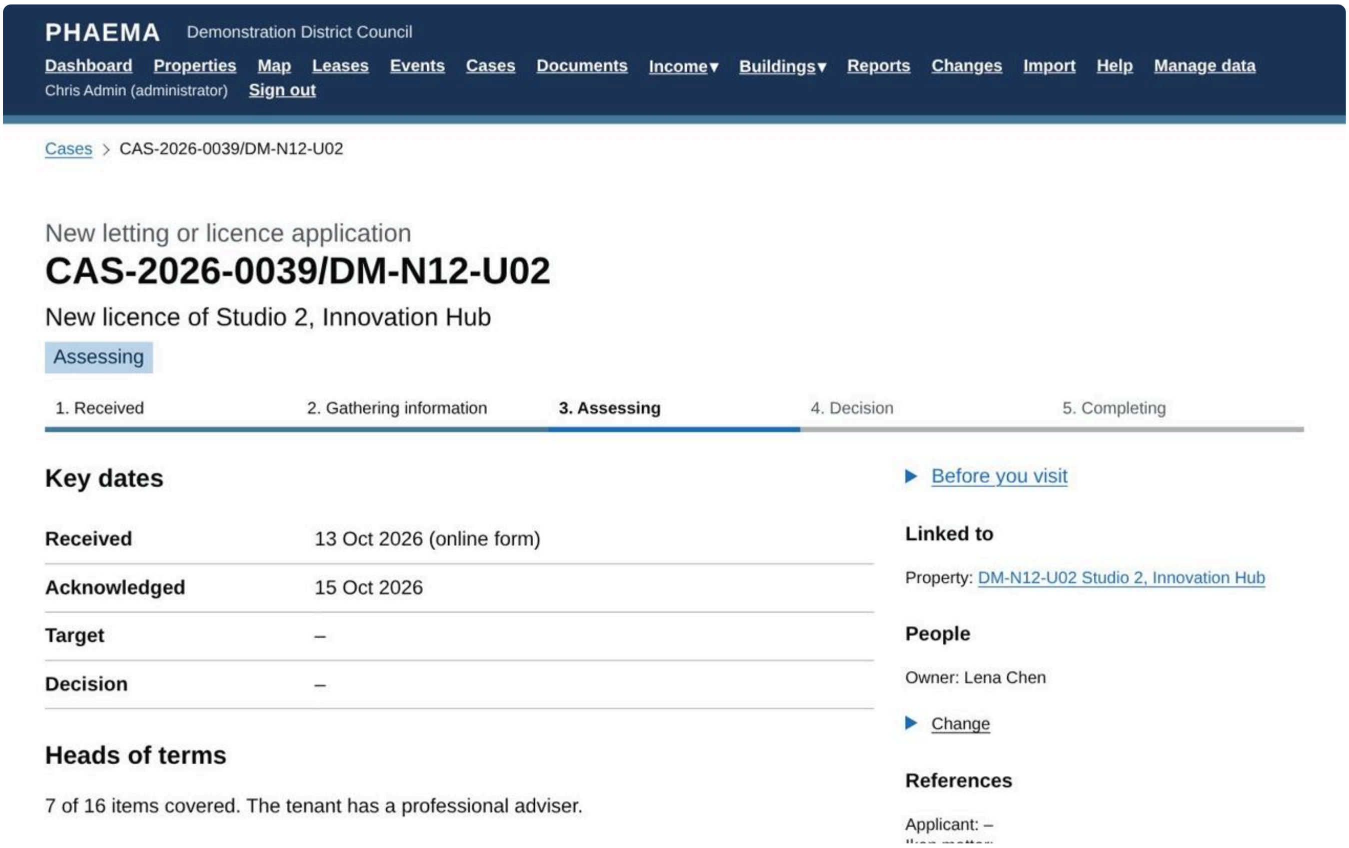
Owner: Rob Baker

References

Applicant: –
Iken matter: –
CRM: DEMO-N3

Until it is approved you cannot record a decision other than Withdrawn, close the case, or record the outcome of its lease event. Nobody can approve their own request; an administrator can send a waiting request to someone else, or approve it.

New lettings and renewals


PHAEMA
Demonstration District Council
Dashboard
Properties
Map
Leases
Events
Cases
Documents
Income▾
Buildings▾
Reports
Changes
Import
Help
Manage data
Chris Admin (administrator)
Sign out
Cases
CAS-2026-0039/DM-N12-U02
1. Received
2. Gathering information
3. Assessing
4. Decision
5. Completing
▶ Before you visit
▶ Change

New letting or licence application

CAS-2026-0039/DM-N12-U02

New licence of Studio 2, Innovation Hub

Assessing

Key dates

Received	13 Oct 2026 (online form)
Acknowledged	15 Oct 2026
Target	–
Decision	–

Heads of terms

7 of 16 items covered. The tenant has a professional adviser.

Linked to

Property: DM-N12-U02 Studio 2, Innovation Hub

People

Owner: Lena Chen

References

Applicant: –

New letting and renewal cases list the 16 heads of terms items the RICS Code for leasing business premises requires. For a renewal, each shows what the current lease says. Record whether the tenant has a professional adviser, and if not, the date you gave them the Code. The case cannot move to Decision until every item is covered.

Renewal cases also record a **section 25 notice** or **section 26 request**. PHAEMA shows the council's counter-notice date and the last day to apply to court, which becomes the target, and warns about dates that do not fit the Act. Check them against the notice: PHAEMA is a reminder, not legal advice.

Dilapidations, MEES and site safety

- **Dilapidations** and expiry cases record the schedule and date served, the tenant's response, the settlement, the council's costs and any deposit held.
- **MEES**: on lettings and renewals, PHAEMA warns if the EPC is rated F or G, has expired or is missing. It is a warning, not a block.
- **Before you visit**: cases, jobs and valuations show site hazards, asbestos information, open compliance actions and whether it is a higher-risk building.

Site visit sheet

Every case that is about a property, or about an agreement over one, has a **Site visit sheet** link. It is one page to take with you on a visit, laid out for a phone and for printing, in four parts:

1. **The case:** reference, type, what it is about, the owner, target date, and the applicant or tenant with their contact details.
2. **Before you visit:** the site hazards recorded for the property, everything it is part of and the buildings within it; what is known about asbestos; open compliance actions; and who occupies the property, with a contact name and phone number.
3. **The property:** the parts of the property record that matter for this type of case, such as the description, construction, services, floor areas, floor plans held, tenancies and other open cases.
4. **On site:** the checklist for this type of case. Where an item checks something on the record, the recorded value is printed beside it, so you confirm it or note the difference. There is space for who visited, when, who you met, notes and measurements.

On a site with several buildings, things checked once (signing in, occupation, photographs) are listed for the visit as a whole, and the items about a building are repeated under each building with that building's own details.

Select **Print** to write on it, or **Download as Word**. Nothing you tick or type on the page is saved: when you are back, add a note and photos to the case, and correct the property record where the visit showed it was wrong. Read the full asbestos register in PHAEMA before any work that disturbs the building.

Notes, emails and documents

File documents and emails takes several files at once. Drag them onto the box from a folder or your desktop, or select **Choose files**, then **File them**: up to 20 at a time. Saved emails (.eml or .msg) are read and filed as correspondence with their attachments; set **Emails were** to Received or Sent first. Every other file is kept as a document named after its file. Anything PHAEMA cannot accept is listed, and the rest are still filed. From Apple Mail you can drag an email straight onto the box; from Outlook, drag the email to your desktop first, then onto the box. The same way of filing works on an agreement's page, under **Documents** (PDFs, with a type of document), and on a property's page, under **Add floor plans or photos**. Wherever PHAEMA asks for a single file, you can drag it onto **Choose file** instead of browsing for it.

File an email (saved from Outlook as .msg or .eml): PHAEMA keeps the email and its attachments. **Log a letter, call or meeting**, **Add a note** (tick Confidential so only the owner and administrators see it), or **Add a document** up to 25 MB. Add **contributors**, such as the legal officer, who can add to the case but change nothing else.

Worked example

Northfield Pharmacy (DL-0511) asks to add a consultation room and new shop front at 1 The Precinct. Rob Baker opens a licence for alterations case, records the acknowledgement and then **Application complete** when the drawings arrive, which sets the 28-day target. He confirms there is no conflict of interest, recommends granting the licence with reinstatement on request, and asks Sam Hughes for approval. Once Sam approves, Rob records the decision and creates the consent letter.

7. Projects

A project is a larger piece of work than a case. It can cover several properties (a development or a programme), properties the council is selling (a disposal), or no property yet: an acquisition starts with a **proposed site**. Select **Projects** in the menu. Each project has a reference such as **PRJ-2026-001**.

Kind	Typical example
Development	Replacing an old building with new units
Acquisition	Buying land for a new depot
Disposal	Selling surplus land in lots
Programme	Energy upgrades across many buildings
Strategic review	An options appraisal for a service's buildings

Starting a project

Administrators and surveyors select **Start a project**, give it a name and kind, choose the lead and add the sponsor and dates. For an acquisition, describe the proposed site and, if known, its title number and the vendor. PHAEMA adds starter tasks for the kind of project. Add colleagues to the **Team** with their role, and outside parties such as agents or architects.

Phases and gateways

A project moves through five phases: **Idea**, **Business case**, **Delivery**, **Completion** and **Close**. It moves on only when a **gateway** decision is recorded: who decided (an officer, Cabinet or a capital board), the outcome, the date, the decision reference and, if you like, the report. **Approved** moves it on, **Deferred** keeps it where it is and **Rejected** stops it. A project can also be paused, restarted or stopped, with a reason.

Milestones, tasks and status

Add milestones with a target date and keep the forecast and achieved dates up to date. The project shows red when a target passes unachieved, and amber when a forecast is later than its target, a task is overdue or the project is paused. Project tasks and milestones you own appear on **My work**, with **My projects**.

Budget

The budget is a set of lines (fees, land, works, contingency, income), each capital or revenue, with **approved**, **forecast** and **actual** figures for each financial year. The project page totals them by year and says how far the forecast is over or under budget. The team, administrators and people with the Finance access area see the budget; the project's managers and finance officers can change it. Finance can load actual spend from the ledger with **Import**, **Project spending**.

Risks and linked work

Record each risk with its likelihood and impact from 1 to 5; PHAEMA multiplies them into a score, highest first, each with an owner and a mitigation. Link cases and maintenance jobs by reference, and asset valuations, that are part of the project; their pages then show **Part of project** to people who can see it.

The proposed site and map

The project page maps its properties. For land not yet on the register, select **Draw the proposed site** and enter one or more HM Land Registry INSPIRE parcel IDs; PHAEMA joins them into the site boundary.

Completion checklist

From delivery onwards the **Completion checklist** shows what the register will need: adding the new property and title after an acquisition, new units after a development, or each property's disposal date and price after a sale. Each step links to the right form, filled in from the project. PHAEMA never changes the register by itself: you save each change and tick the step. Steps marked "checked by PHAEMA" tick themselves, such as a disposal once its date is recorded. A disposed property shows **Disposed of** and drops out of open data.

Confidential projects

Confidential projects, including every acquisition when it starts, are seen only by their team and administrators: others cannot find them in lists, on property pages or in reports, and their documents open only from the project page. Every opening is recorded under **Who has opened it**, which the lead and administrators can see.

Worked example

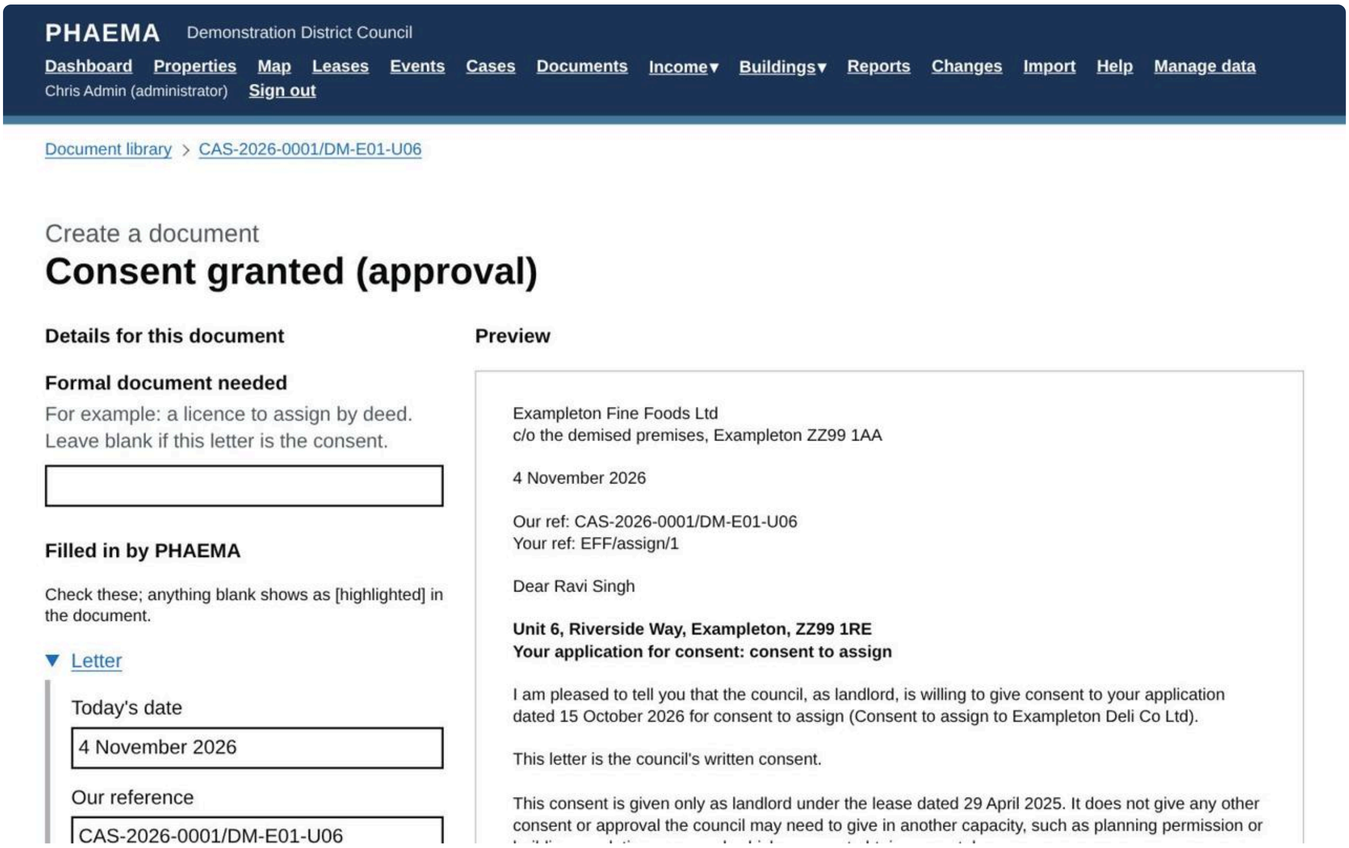
PRJ-2026-001 Northfield Business Park phase 2 replaces the Hangar block with twelve light industrial units. Gateway 1 is approved and the business case is due at Cabinet, but its forecast is later than the target, so the project shows amber. **PRJ-2026-002 Depot site acquisition, Mill Lane** is confidential: Cabinet approved it at gateway 2, and its checklist is ready to add the land and its title once the purchase completes. **PRJ-2026-003** is selling two surplus sites; each lot ticks itself off when its disposal is recorded.

8. Document library

The document library holds templates for the letters and notices estates work needs. PHAEMA fills them in from its records and gives you a Word document to check, finalise and issue. Find it under **Documents**.

Creating a document

Most documents start from a case: select **Create a letter or notice** to see the templates for that type of case. Letters about an agreement, such as an arrears reminder, are on the agreement's page; the valuer's instruction is on the valuation's page.


PHAEMA
Demonstration District Council
Dashboard
Properties
Map
Leases
Events
Cases
Documents
Income▾
Buildings▾
Reports
Changes
Import
Help
Manage data
Chris Admin (administrator)
Sign out
Document library
CAS-2026-0001/DM-E01-U06

Create a document

Consent granted (approval)

Details for this document

Formal document needed

For example: a licence to assign by deed. Leave blank if this letter is the consent.

Filled in by PHAEMA

Check these; anything blank shows as [highlighted] in the document.

▼ Letter

Today's date: 4 November 2026

Our reference: CAS-2026-0001/DM-E01-U06

Preview

Exampleton Fine Foods Ltd
c/o the demised premises, Exampleton ZZ99 1AA

4 November 2026

Our ref: CAS-2026-0001/DM-E01-U06
Your ref: EFF/assign/1

Dear Ravi Singh

Unit 6, Riverside Way, Exampleton, ZZ99 1RE
Your application for consent: consent to assign

I am pleased to tell you that the council, as landlord, is willing to give consent to your application dated 15 October 2026 for consent to assign (Consent to assign to Exampleton Deli Co Ltd).

This letter is the council's written consent.

This consent is given only as landlord under the lease dated 29 April 2025. It does not give any other consent or approval the council may need to give in another capacity, such as planning permission or

1. Answer any questions the template asks, such as the conditions of a consent.
2. Check the details PHAEMA filled in. Changes here affect this document only.
3. Select **Update the preview**. Anything PHAEMA could not fill in shows in [square brackets], highlighted yellow.
4. Select **Download as Word**. From a case, a copy of the draft is kept on the case unless you untick the box.

Finalise in Word, issue it, and file the signed copy back on the case.

The templates supplied

Group	Templates
Consents and licences	Acknowledgement; request for information; costs undertaking; consent granted; consent with conditions; consent refused; approval of an activity; instruction to legal
1954 Act notices	Section 25 not opposing and opposing (particulars); counter-notice to a section 26 request; acknowledgement of a section 26 request; section 40 request (particulars); contracting out
Other notices	Section 146 notice; section 17 notice (particulars)

Group	Templates
Lettings and renewals	Heads of terms; letter to an unrepresented tenant enclosing the RICS Code
Rent	Rent review proposal; rent review memorandum
Arrears	Arrears reminder; final notice before action
Lease management	Break notice acknowledgement; breach of covenant; dilapidations covering letter; deposit return
Asset valuation	Instruction and terms of engagement; response to the auditor
General	Enquiry acknowledgement; general letter

Prescribed forms

Some notices must use a form prescribed by law, such as section 25 notices. For these PHAEMA produces the **particulars** (names, premises, dates, grounds) with a checklist and a red warning naming the form. Put them on the current official form and have the council's legal team check it before it is served. All templates are starting points, not legal advice.

Adding and changing templates

Administrators select **Manage templates** to change a template, save the council's own copy, or add a new one. Templates use fields such as `{{ tenant_name }}`, simple formatting, `[[signature]]` for the signature block, and questions for details the author supplies. The letterhead comes from **Module settings**, under Letters and notices.

9. Rent ledger

The rent ledger charges rent on agreements the council lets out, records payments from the finance system and shows what each tenant owes. When it is switched on, **Rents** appears under **Income**.

Who raises the invoices

In settings the council chooses either that **PHAEMA numbers the invoices** (for example PH000123) and finance records them, or that **the finance system raises the invoices** from PHAEMA's charges (referenced PHC000123). Either way, charges go to finance in the finance export and receipts come back by import.

Raising rent

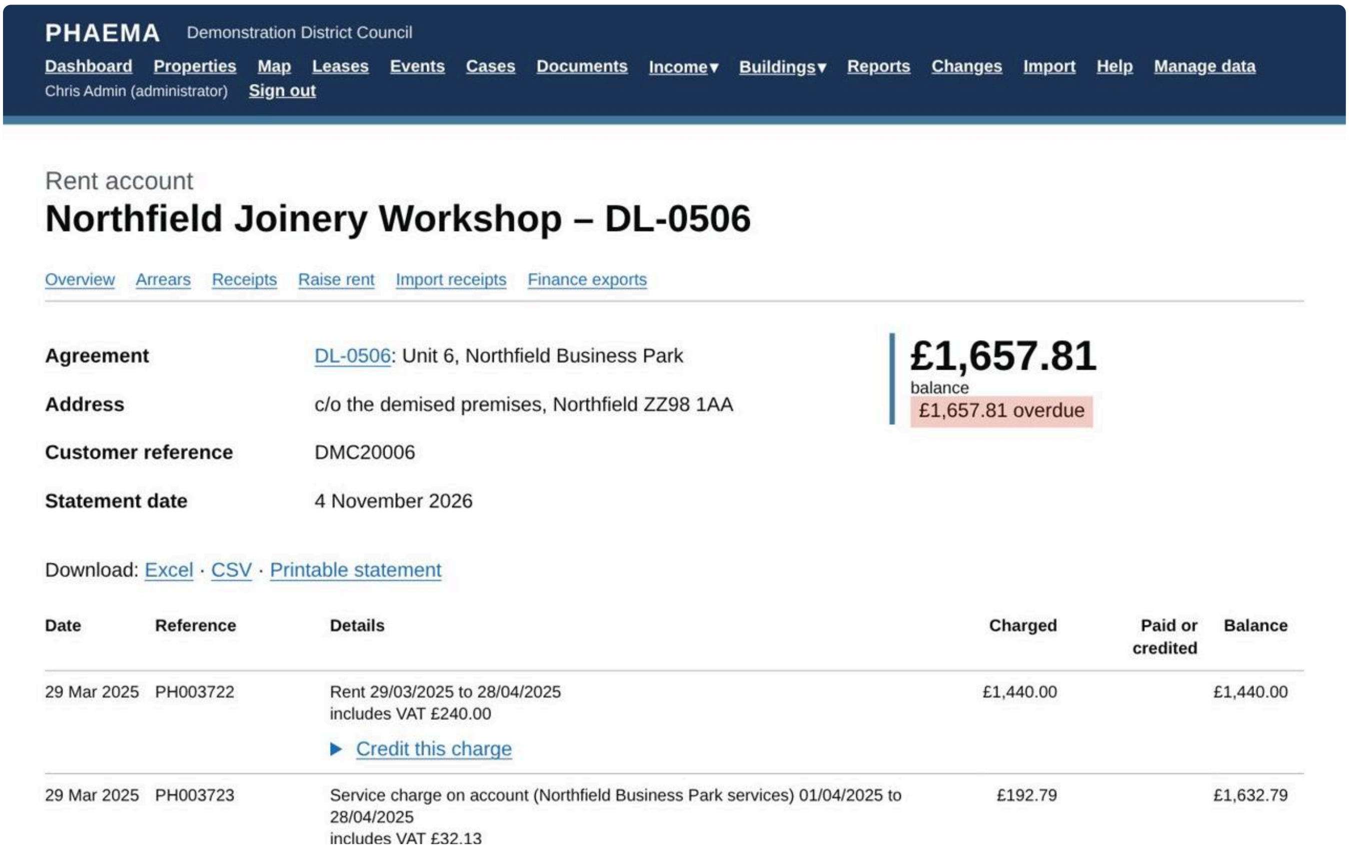
Administrators select **Rents**, **Raise rent**, choose the payment dates to charge and the issue date, select **Preview the charges**, check the list, then **Raise these charges**.

- Rent is due in advance on each payment date, at the rent in force on the first day of the period.
- Part periods are apportioned by day (annual rent × days ÷ 365).
- VAT is added where the agreement is marked VAT chargeable.
- Peppercorn agreements and those the council holds are not charged.
- With service charges on, the same run charges service charge on account.
- **A period is only ever charged once**, so runs can overlap safely.

Agreements with **rent demands on hold** are left out of the run, for both rent and service charges, and the preview names them with the reason. Put an agreement on hold in **Edit this agreement**. When the hold is taken off, run the same dates again and PHAEMA raises what was missed.

Charges cannot be deleted: correct mistakes with a credit note.

Rent accounts


PHAEMA
Demonstration District Council
Dashboard
Properties
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Leases
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Cases
Documents
Income▾
Buildings▾
Reports
Changes
Import
Help
Manage data
Chris Admin (administrator)
Sign out
Overview
Arrears
Receipts
Raise rent
Import receipts
Finance exports
▶ Credit this charge

Rent account

Northfield Joinery Workshop – DL-0506

Agreement	DL-0506: Unit 6, Northfield Business Park
Address	c/o the demised premises, Northfield ZZ98 1AA
Customer reference	DMC20006
Statement date	4 November 2026

£1,657.81
balance
£1,657.81 overdue

Download: Excel · CSV · Printable statement

Date	Reference	Details	Charged	Paid or credited	Balance
29 Mar 2025	PH003722	Rent 29/03/2025 to 28/04/2025 includes VAT £240.00	£1,440.00		£1,440.00
29 Mar 2025	PH003723	Service charge on account (Northfield Business Park services) 01/04/2025 to 28/04/2025 includes VAT £32.13	£192.79		£1,632.79

Each agreement's account lists every charge and payment with a running balance. Payments are set against the oldest debt first. Download it to Excel or open the printable statement to send to the tenant.

The account and the statement use the agreement's **billing contact** where one is set, and the tenant's main contact otherwise.

Credit notes

Administrators open **Credit this charge** on the account, enter the amount (or leave it blank for the whole charge) and a reason. VAT is credited in proportion, and the credit goes to finance in the next export.

Receipts

Payments are imported from the finance system under **Rents**, **Import receipts**. Each is matched by lease reference, then the invoice reference quoted, then the customer reference if that customer has a single agreement. Importing the same file twice is safe.

Arrears

Rents, **Arrears** lists every agreement with overdue rent, aged into 1 to 30, 31 to 60, 61 to 90 and over 90 days. The dashboard shows total arrears and the collection rate: rent received in the last 12 months as a percentage of rent that fell due.

An agreement whose debt has been **passed to external debt collectors or to legal** is tagged on the list with the date. Record it in **Edit this agreement**, under Rent demands and arrears. Filter the list to show only those passed over, or only those still with the council; the download has the same columns.

The finance export

Rents, **Finance exports** collects every charge and credit note not yet sent into a numbered export, in Excel or CSV, with fixed columns (record type, references, customer, lease, premises, UPRN, description, period, dates, net, VAT code and rate, VAT, gross, income code). Each charge is exported once.

The export's customer address is the agreement's billing address where one is set. Two columns at the end, **Billing contact** and **Billing email**, give the billing contact, or the tenant's main contact if none is set. They were added at the end so that a finance system's existing column mapping is not disturbed.

Worked example

Northfield Joinery Workshop (DL-0506) pays £14,400 a year monthly in advance, plus VAT: £1,440 a month. Its account shows the last two monthly charges unpaid, so it appears on the Arrears list. Northfield Bakery (DL-0514) has paid part of its latest charge, which shows as the balance on that charge.

10. Service charges

Service charges recover the cost of shared services, such as estate roads, landscaping, security and cleaning, from the tenants who benefit. The module needs the rent ledger, because service charges are demanded and collected through it. It follows the RICS professional standard *Service charges in commercial property* (2nd edition): a budget before the year, payments on account, and a year-end statement reconciling actual costs, with all income credited.

Schedules and shares

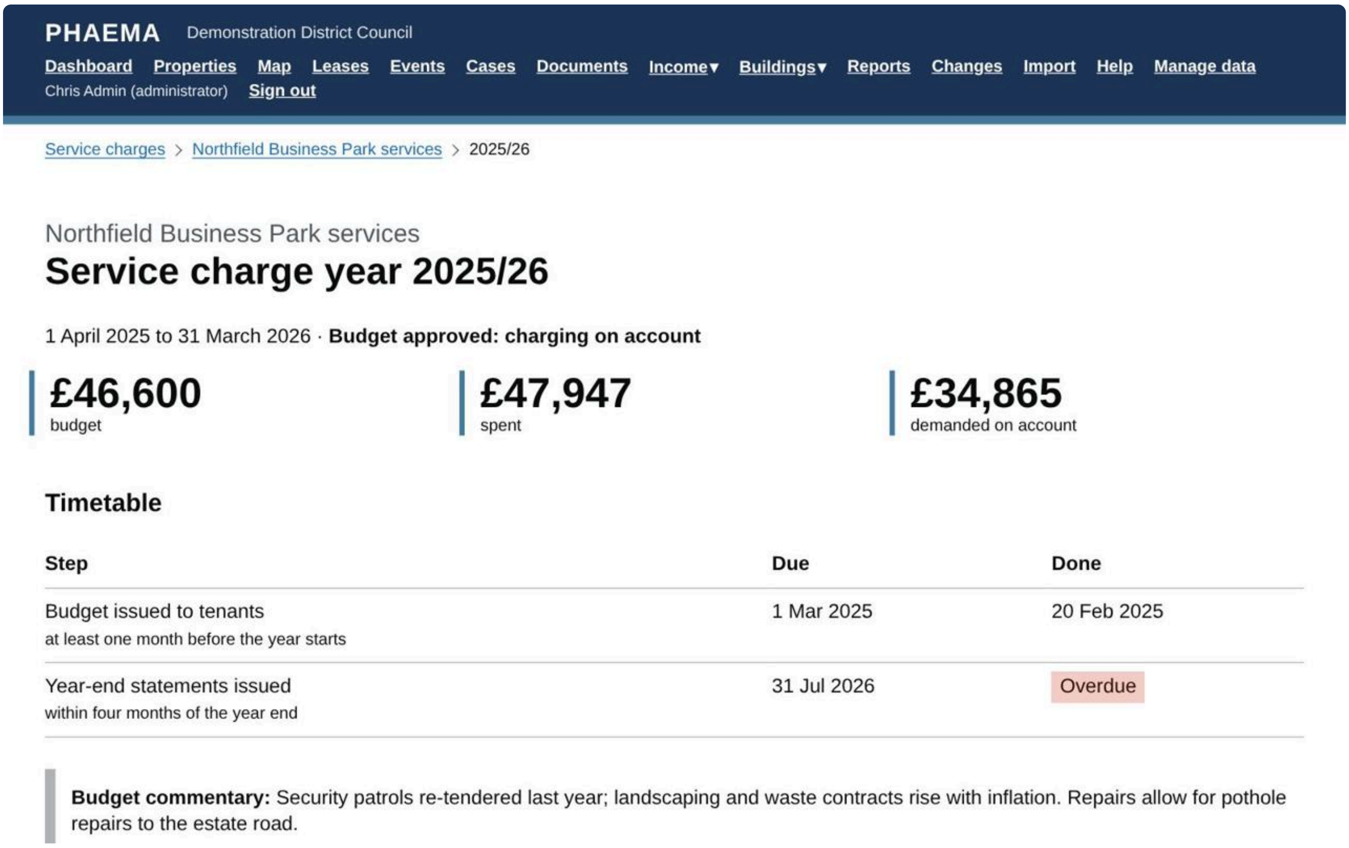
A schedule is one pool of shared costs. Administrators set out the properties covered, how costs are shared (floor area, fixed percentages or equally per unit), when the year starts, and the contributing leases, each with any annual cap. Shares are worked out over all lettable units **including empty ones**: the council pays the share of any unit not let.

Budgets and payments on account

Add the budget by heading, with a **budget commentary** explaining main changes and planned works, then select **Approve the budget**. Each lease has a printable budget statement. From then on, every demand run also charges each lease its share as service charge on account, on its rent payment dates.

Spending

Record actual costs on the year, or import them from finance (**Import**, **Service charge spending**). Record **income** such as interest, rebates and insurance commissions so it reduces the total shared. Untick **Recoverable** for costs the leases do not allow. Mark **Improvements** (recoverable only if tenants agreed) and **Building Safety Act defects** (never recoverable).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Chris Admin (administrator)
Sign out
Service charges > Northfield Business Park services > 2025/26

Northfield Business Park services

Service charge year 2025/26

1 April 2025 to 31 March 2026 · **Budget approved: charging on account**

£46,600	£47,947	£34,865
budget	spent	demanded on account

Timetable

Step	Due	Done
Budget issued to tenants at least one month before the year starts	1 Mar 2025	20 Feb 2025
Year-end statements issued within four months of the year end	31 Jul 2026	Overdue

Budget commentary: Security patrols re-tendered last year; landscaping and waste contracts rise with inflation. Repairs allow for pothole repairs to the estate road.

Timetable

The budget should reach tenants at least one month before the year starts, and year-end statements within four months of the year end. The year page shows both due dates and what you recorded, and administrators get a list of deadlines every Monday. If you record either as issued late, PHAEMA asks for the reason, which is printed on the documents with an apology.

Apportionment matrix and year end

The **Apportionment matrix** shows every heading split between the leases and the council. After the year ends, select **Reconcile the year**. For each lease PHAEMA takes its share of actual spending, scaled by the days it was in force, limited by any cap, less what was charged on account, and raises a **balancing charge** or **balancing credit** on the rent account. Each lease has a printable year-end statement.

Worked example

Northfield Business Park services shares the gatehouse security, roads, landscaping, CCTV and waste between eight leases by floor area. Units 4 and 10 are empty, so the council pays their shares. DL-0509's lease caps its service charge at £1,800 a year, so anything above that falls on the council too.

11. Maintenance

Maintenance links repairs to the lease: who pays is worked out from the repairing terms, and the cost can go straight to the tenant's rent account or the service charge. It appears under **Buildings**, with an **Overview** of emergencies, jobs past target, overdue statutory tasks, contracts to re-tender and contractors whose insurance is running out.

Reporting a repair

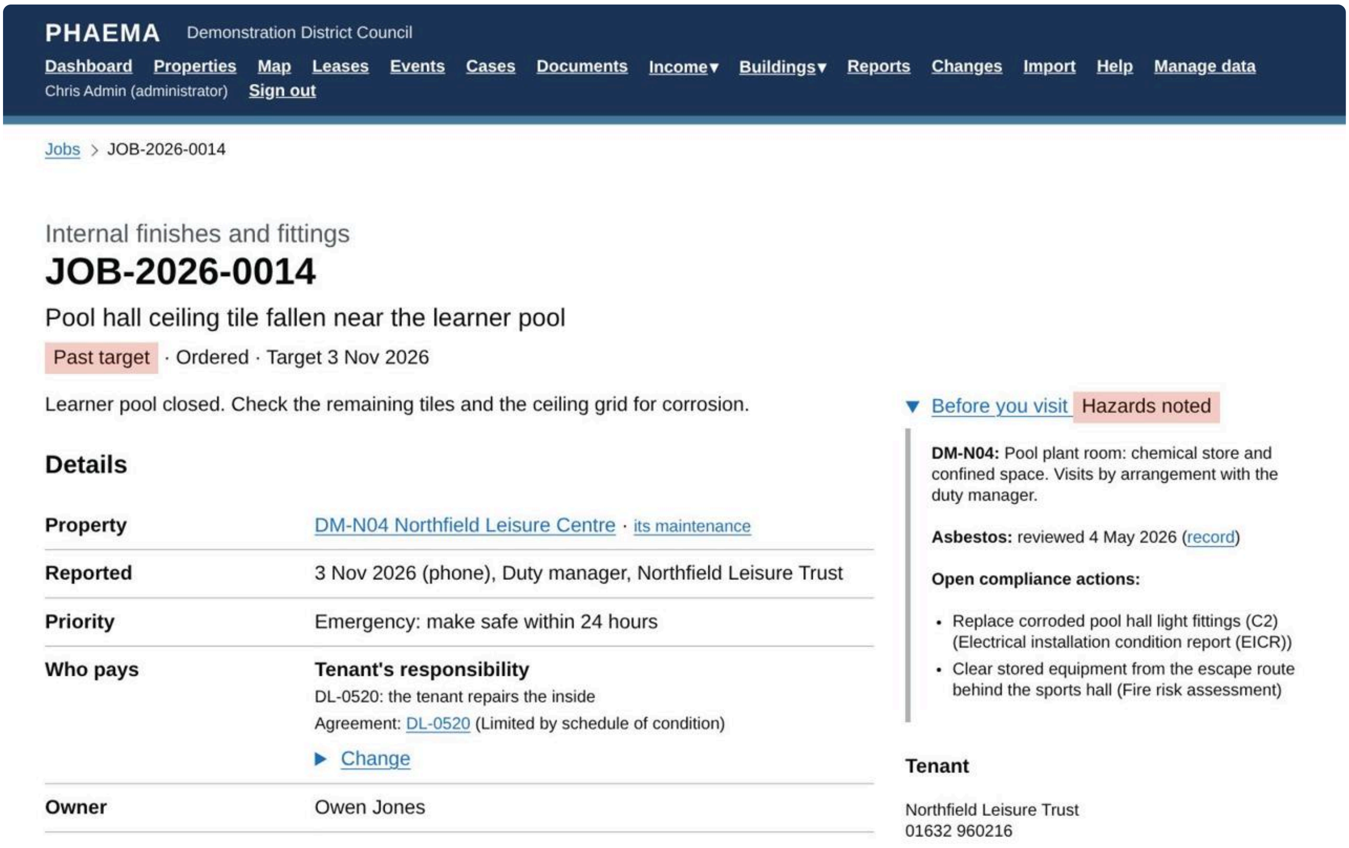
Select **Report a repair**, choose the property, say what needs doing, and choose a category and priority. Weekends and bank holidays are not counted. Each job gets a number such as JOB-2026-0042, which is also the works order number.

Priority	Target
Emergency	Make safe the same day
Urgent	Within 5 working days
Routine	Within 20 working days
Planned	The planned task's due date

Who pays

Lease	Inside	Structure, roof and exterior
Full repairing	Tenant	Tenant
Internal repairing, or limited by a schedule	Tenant	Council, through the service charge if there is one
Landlord repairs	Council (service charge if any)	Council (service charge if any)
Not let	Council	Council

The suggestion is a starting point: change it on the job with a reason, for example **Council, recharged to the tenant** for damage they caused. Always check the lease for anything unusual.



Internal finishes and fittings

JOB-2026-0014

Pool hall ceiling tile fallen near the learner pool

Past target · Ordered · Target 3 Nov 2026

Learner pool closed. Check the remaining tiles and the ceiling grid for corrosion.

Details

Property	DM-N04 Northfield Leisure Centre · its maintenance
Reported	3 Nov 2026 (phone), Duty manager, Northfield Leisure Trust
Priority	Emergency: make safe within 24 hours
Who pays	**Tenant's responsibility** DL-0520: the tenant repairs the inside Agreement: DL-0520 (Limited by schedule of condition) ▶ Change
Owner	Owen Jones

▼ Before you visit Hazards noted

DM-N04: Pool plant room: chemical store and confined space. Visits by arrangement with the duty manager.

Asbestos: reviewed 4 May 2026 (record)

Open compliance actions:

- Replace corroded pool hall light fittings (C2) (Electrical installation condition report (EICR))
- Clear stored equipment from the escape route behind the sports hall (Fire risk assessment)

Tenant

Northfield Leisure Trust
01632 960216

Works orders and approval

Choose the contractor, enter the estimate and any purchase order number, then **Issue the works order**; PHAEMA can email it, and warns if the contractor's insurance has expired. Orders above the approval limit (£5,000 by default) need your supervisor's approval first. If the estimate changes after approval, it needs approving again.

Completing and paying

Record the completion date, work done, final cost and invoice number, and add photos or certificates. For a recharge, select **Recharge the cost** to charge the tenant's rent account. For the service charge, choose the year and heading. Close the job when everything is settled.

Planned maintenance and components

Add tasks from the library on a property's maintenance page adds common statutory and planned tasks (gas safety, EICR, fire alarm servicing, emergency lighting, legionella, asbestos re-inspection, lift examinations and more) with their usual frequency. PHAEMA raises a job 28 days before each is due; completing it sets the next date. Check frequencies against your own risk assessments.

The component register records roofs, boilers, lifts and other parts with year installed, expected life, condition (A good to D bad) and replacement cost. The **Lifecycle forecast** shows replacements due over 5 to 30 years, split between capital and revenue.

Contractors and contracts

Administrators record contractors with contacts, out of hours number, insurer, cover, insurance expiry and accreditations. The contracts register shows when each service contract is due to be re-tendered or benchmarked (at least every three years, as the RICS service charge standard expects).

Worked example

At **Northfield Leisure Centre** a ceiling tile has fallen near the learner pool: an emergency, ordered the same day, and the job's **Before you visit** panel warns about the pool plant room. At **Northfield Market Hall**, replacing cracked roof-lantern panes is estimated at £14,800, above the approval limit, so the order waits for Sam Hughes.

12. Compliance and building information

The compliance module keeps the certificates each building needs, warns before they expire, tracks the actions they call for, and holds the building's information (the Golden Thread) for its whole life. Find it under **Buildings**, **Compliance**, and on each property page.

Setting up a property

On a property's compliance page, select **Choose the certificates this property needs**. Typical periods:

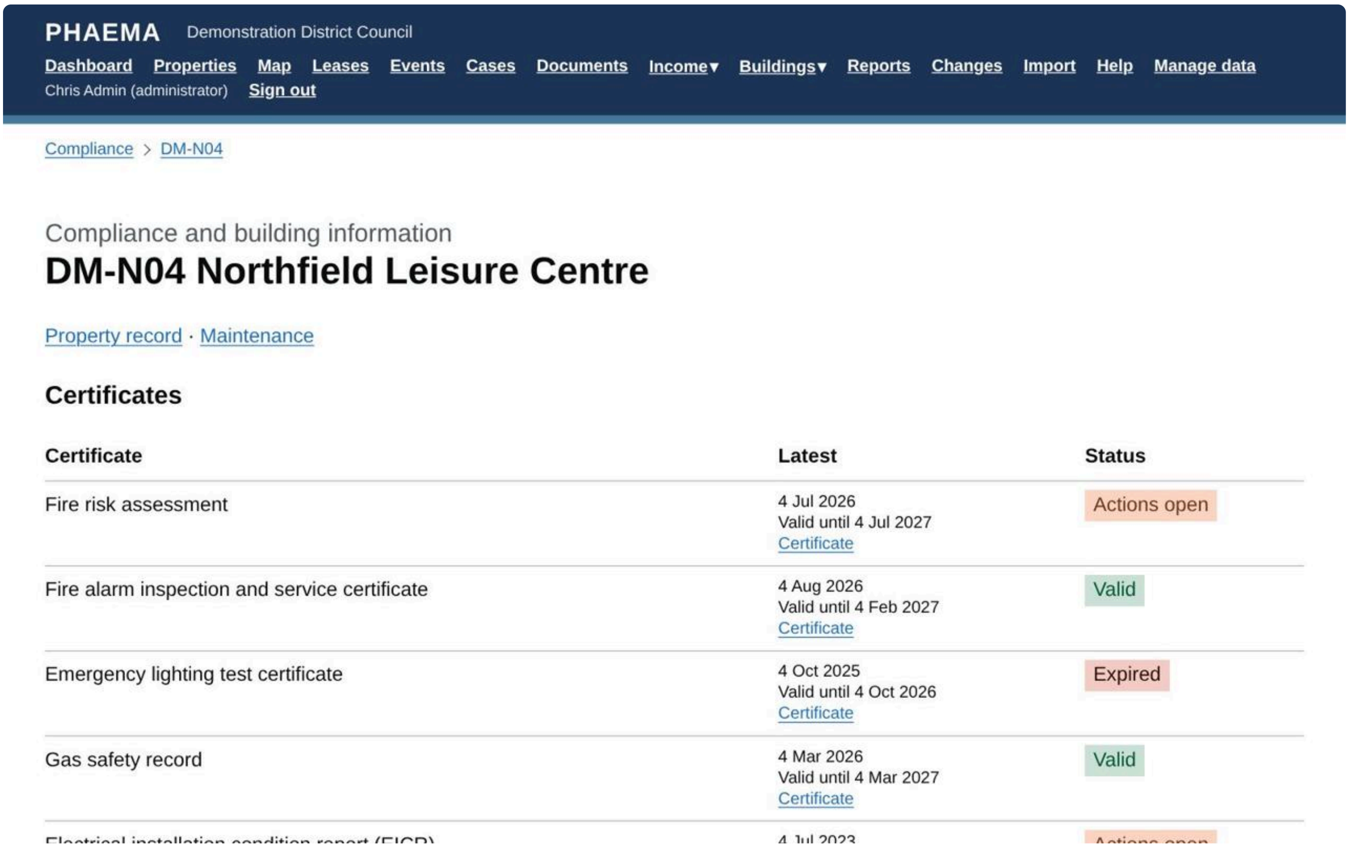
Certificate	Usually valid for
Fire risk assessment	12 months (review)
Fire alarm inspection and service	6 months
Emergency lighting test	12 months
Gas safety record	12 months
Electrical installation condition report	5 years
Legionella risk assessment	2 years
Asbestos register review	12 months
Lift thorough examination	6 months

Certificate	Usually valid for
Energy Performance Certificate	10 years
Display Energy Certificate	12 months

Administrators can change the periods or add types. PHAEMA suggests who holds each certificate: a tenant on full repairing terms of the whole property holds its own and the council keeps a copy.

Recording a certificate

Select **Record a certificate**, enter the date, the result and the PDF, and the rating for an EPC or DEC. Statuses are **Valid**, **Actions open**, **Expires soon** (within 60 days), and **Expired**, **Missing** or **Unsatisfactory**, which show red. Type any **remedial actions** one per line with a priority: high (7 days), medium (30) or low (90). Each is tracked until done, and **Raise a repair job** turns one into a job.


PHAEMA
Demonstration District Council
Dashboard
Properties
Map
Leases
Events
Cases
Documents
Income▾
Buildings▾
Reports
Changes
Import
Help
Manage data
Chris Admin (administrator)
Sign out
Compliance > DM-N04

Compliance and building information

DM-N04 Northfield Leisure Centre

Property record · Maintenance

Certificates

Certificate	Latest	Status
Fire risk assessment	4 Jul 2026 Valid until 4 Jul 2027 Certificate	Actions open
Fire alarm inspection and service certificate	4 Aug 2026 Valid until 4 Feb 2027 Certificate	Valid
Emergency lighting test certificate	4 Oct 2025 Valid until 4 Oct 2026 Certificate	Expired
Gas safety record	4 Mar 2026 Valid until 4 Mar 2027 Certificate	Valid

Golden Thread tiers

Tier	For
A, statutory	Higher-risk buildings in England (18 m or 7 storeys, with at least two homes) and in-scope buildings in Wales
B, best practice	Other buildings under the Fire Safety Order
C, minimal	Land and simple assets

Use **Screen this building** to record the country, height, storeys, homes and responsible person. PHAEMA suggests the tier and an officer confirms it.

Building information

Add a document or a new version keeps plans, fire safety information, health and safety files, manuals and surveys. A new version supersedes the old one, which is kept: building information is never deleted.

Open data

When an administrator ticks **Publish open data**, PHAEMA publishes the Transparency Code land and assets list and the list of available property at /open-data/, as CSV, JSON and GeoJSON under the Open Government Licence. Properties marked **Exclude from open data** never appear.

Worked example

Northfield Leisure Centre needs ten certificates. Its air conditioning inspection (TM44) is missing and its emergency lighting test has expired. The fire risk assessment is in date but has an action open (clear the escape route behind the sports hall). Its tier is B, with the leisure trust as responsible person day to day.

13. Asset valuation

The asset valuation module manages the valuations the council needs for its accounts, following the CIPFA Code of Practice on Local Authority Accounting and the RICS Red Book. Find it under **Buildings**, **Asset valuation**.

Finance's criteria

Finance sets, under **Manage data**, the asset classes (basis, how often revalued, index, depreciation), the year end, the de minimis, the componentisation threshold and valuer rotation. PHAEMA starts with the CIPFA classes:

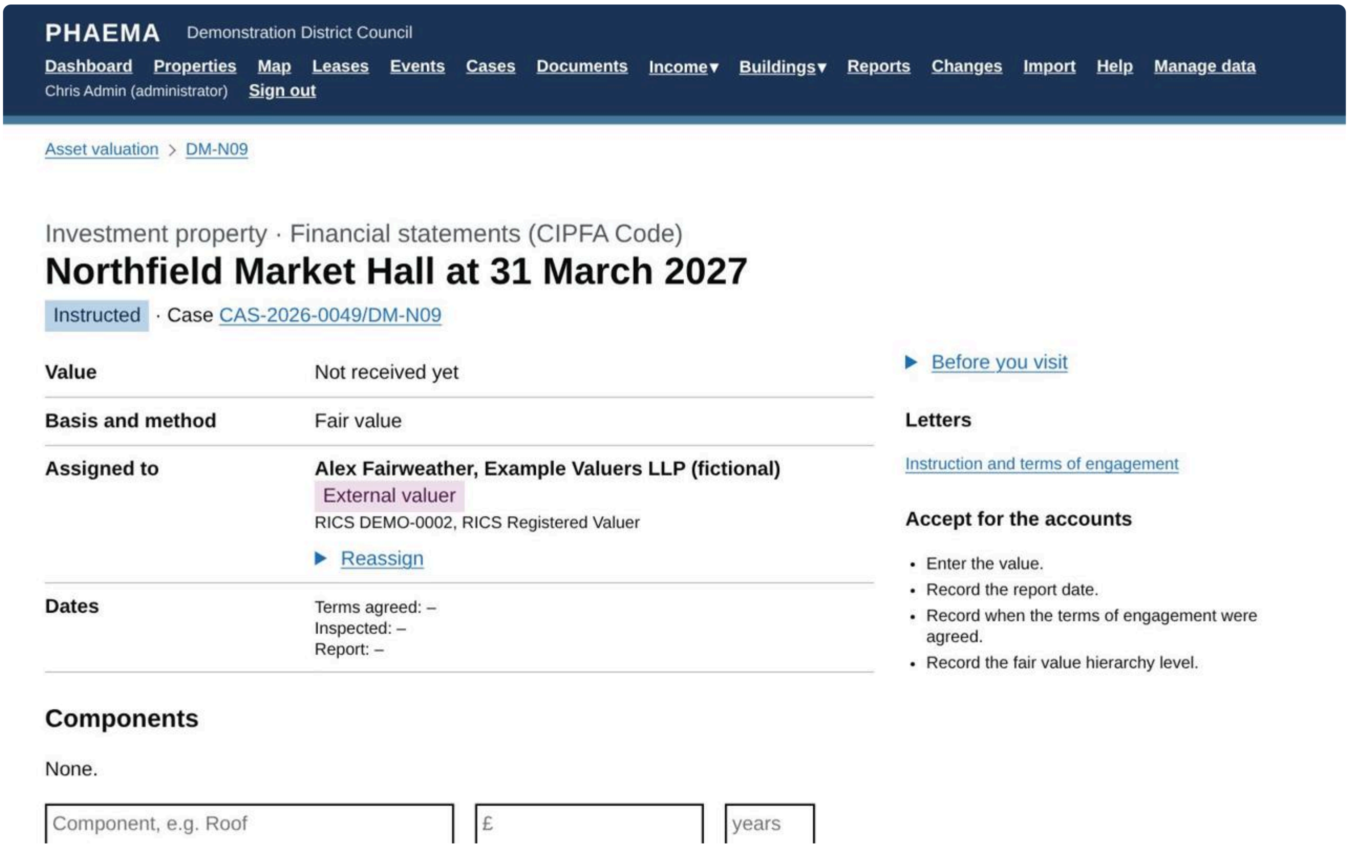
Class	Basis	Revalued
Other land and buildings	Existing use value; DRC for specialised buildings	Every 5 years
Investment property	Fair value	Every year
Surplus assets	Fair value	Every 5 years
Held for sale	Lower of carrying amount and fair value less costs to sell	Every year
Heritage, community, under construction	As finance decides, or historic cost	Not revalued by default

Classify each top-level property (the first time, **Classify them from their holding purpose**); reclassify with a date and reason, and the history is kept.

The yearly programme

The page lists the assets due at the year end and why. Download the **valuer's data pack**, then **Start the programme** (administrators), which opens a programme case and an asset valuation case for each asset.

Initial valuation report. Every case in the Asset valuation group that is about a property has an **Initial valuation report** link. It brings together for the valuer the property's key facts, location, description, construction and services (each building on a site in turn), floor areas and their basis, the floor plans held, titles with their restrictions, current tenancies and other agreements with their term, rent, review, breaks, security of tenure, repairs and permitted use, and the other open cases. It ends with a list of anything a valuer usually needs that has not been recorded. It is drawn from the records as they are when you open it, so correct the property or agreement and open it again. Select **Download as Word** to add your own comments and send it, then file the version you sent on the case. It is background information, not a valuation.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Chris Admin (administrator)
Sign out
Asset valuation
DM-N09
▶ Before you visit
▶ Reassign
Component, e.g. Roof
£
years

Investment property · Financial statements (CIPFA Code)

Northfield Market Hall at 31 March 2027

Instructed · Case CAS-2026-0049/DM-N09

Value	Not received yet
Basis and method	Fair value
Assigned to	**Alex Fairweather, Example Valuers LLP (fictional)** External valuer RICS DEMO-0002, RICS Registered Valuer
Dates	Terms agreed: – Inspected: – Report: –

Letters

Instruction and terms of engagement

Accept for the accounts

- Enter the value.
- Record the report date.
- Record when the terms of engagement were agreed.
- Record the fair value hierarchy level.

Components

None.

Assigning and recording

Assign each valuation to a member of staff or an external valuer; staff are emailed and see it on their dashboard. Record the basis, method, purpose, terms of engagement date, valuation and report dates, inspection and its extent, assumptions, any material uncertainty, the valuer's status and RICS number, conflicts declared, the **fair value level** for fair value, the value split into land and buildings, remaining life, components and the report. Values can also be imported from the valuer's returned figures.

Accepting for the accounts

An administrator selects **Accept** once the valuation is complete. PHAEMA will not accept a valuation without its essentials, or a building over the componentisation threshold without components. Accepted valuations are locked.

Audit

1. **Flag for audit** with the reason, the auditor, their query and the response date.
2. **Record the response sent to the auditor**, with any evidence.
3. **Close** with the outcome: no change, amended, accounts adjusted, or other.

The **Audit** page lists every flagged valuation and downloads the log for the auditor.

Impairment and indexation

PHAEMA prompts an impairment review after a change of occupation or purpose, a lease ending, an emergency repair or a component graded D. Between full valuations it applies each class's index to bring the last value forward to the year end (to the buildings only when land and buildings are split). The **Year-end schedule for finance** gives every asset's value, valuer, fair value level and indexed value.

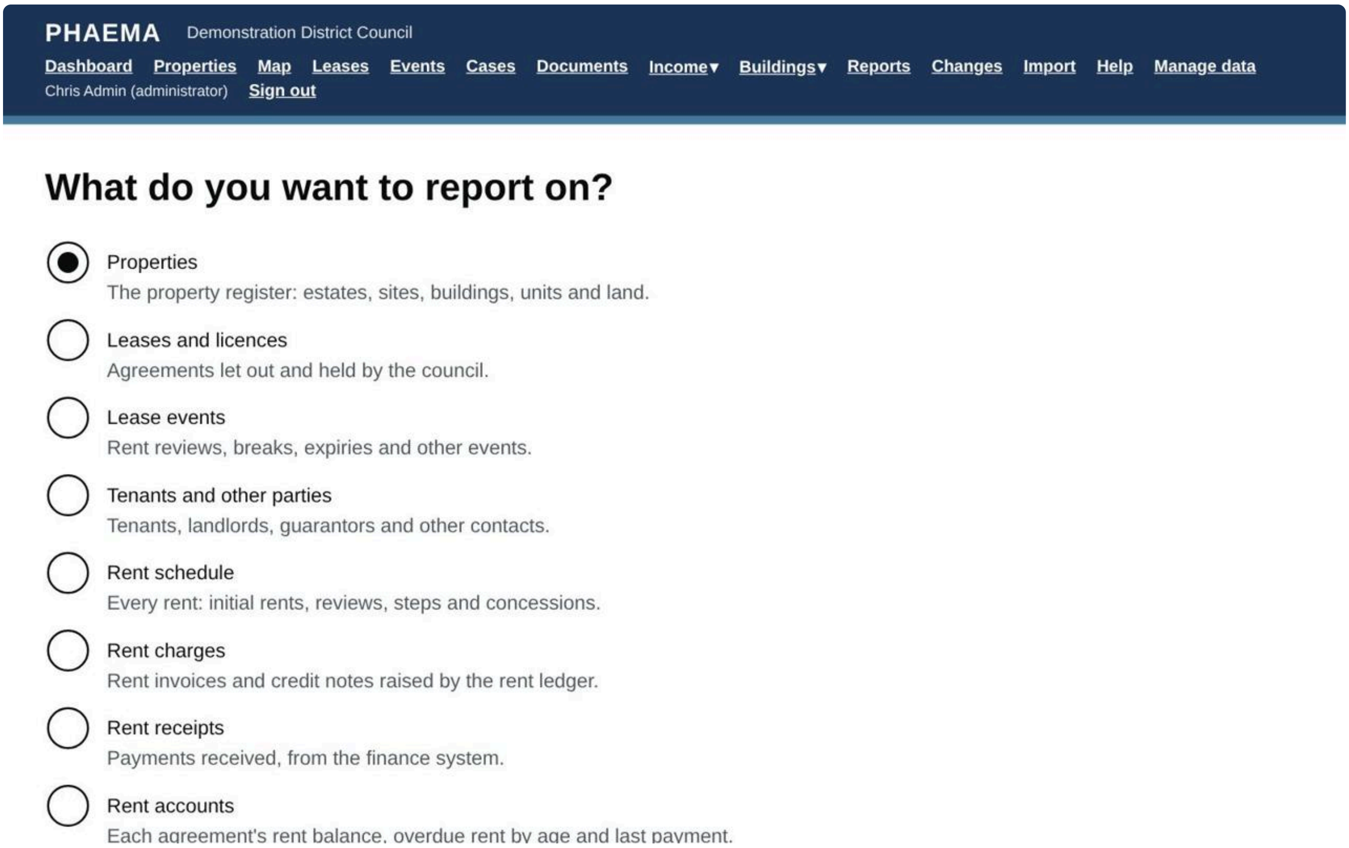
Worked example

This year, the water tower telecoms site (DM-N07) and Hilltop Farm (DM-N10) are assigned to Lena Chen as a council staff valuer; the rest of Northfield goes to the external valuer. Last year's valuation of **Northfield Market Hall** is flagged for audit: the auditor asked about the turnover rent assumption and the yield, and Rob Baker is preparing the response.

14. Reports, data in and out, and the change log

Reports

Select **Reports**. Any report can be viewed on screen or downloaded to Excel or CSV, and always shows the data as it is now. Ready-made reports are grouped by topic: property and assets, leases and key dates, cases, rents and income, service charges, maintenance, compliance, asset valuation, contacts and data quality. Those for an optional module appear when it is on.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Sign out

What do you want to report on?

● Properties
The property register: estates, sites, buildings, units and land.

○ Leases and licences
Agreements let out and held by the council.

○ Lease events
Rent reviews, breaks, expiries and other events.

○ Tenants and other parties
Tenants, landlords, guarantors and other contacts.

○ Rent schedule
Every rent: initial rents, reviews, steps and concessions.

○ Rent charges
Rent invoices and credit notes raised by the rent ledger.

○ Rent receipts
Payments received, from the finance system.

○ Rent accounts
Each agreement's rent balance, overdue rent by age and last payment.

To build your own, select **Make a new report**, choose what to report on, then:

1. **Columns**: tick those you want, and number them to set the order.
2. **Filters**: lists of choices, text (or blank), at least and at most for money and areas, and dates in the next or last so many days. Relative dates move with time.
3. **Sort by** one column, largest or latest first if you want.
4. **Show totals** for money and area columns.

Select **Save and run**. Tick **Share this report with everyone** to let colleagues run and copy it; only you and administrators can change it.

Importing

Administrators select **Import**. Import in this order: properties, parties, leases and licences with their breaks, then Land Registry boundaries. Rent receipts, service charge spending, contractors and components, and the valuer's figures are imported the same way.

1. Download the **Excel template**, with drop-downs, an example row and a Guidance sheet.
2. Fill in one row per record.
3. Upload it and check the preview: what will be added, updated or unchanged.
4. If any row has a problem, **nothing is imported**; the preview lists each problem by sheet and row.
5. When the preview is clean, select **Import these records.**

Existing records are matched and updated; empty cells leave values unchanged. Change an existing agreement's rent on its rent schedule, never by import.

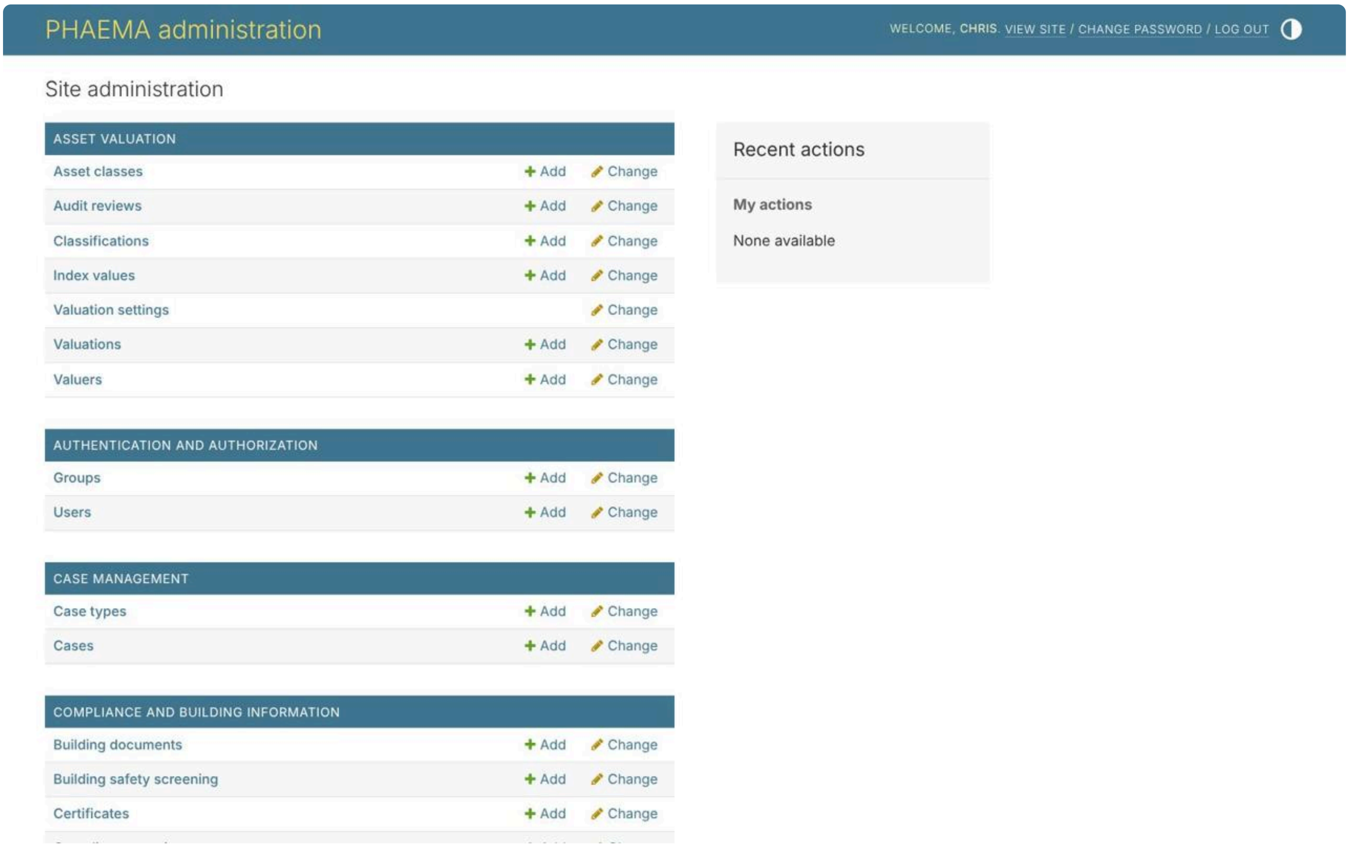
Exporting

Every list has **Download Excel** and **Download CSV**, with everything matching your filters, in your order. Downloaded files are outside PHAEMA's access controls: store and share them under the council's information governance rules.

The change log

Every addition, change and deletion is recorded with who, when and the old and new values, including imports (under the administrator who confirmed them) and automatic tasks (shown as System). The change log cannot be edited or deleted by anyone. Select **Changes** to see it, filter by person, open an entry for the detail, or download it.

15. Administration



Site administration

ASSET VALUATION		
Asset classes	+ Add	✎ Change
Audit reviews	+ Add	✎ Change
Classifications	+ Add	✎ Change
Index values	+ Add	✎ Change
Valuation settings		✎ Change
Valuations	+ Add	✎ Change
Valuers	+ Add	✎ Change

AUTHENTICATION AND AUTHORIZATION		
Groups	+ Add	✎ Change
Users	+ Add	✎ Change

CASE MANAGEMENT		
Case types	+ Add	✎ Change
Cases	+ Add	✎ Change

COMPLIANCE AND BUILDING INFORMATION		
Building documents	+ Add	✎ Change
Building safety screening	+ Add	✎ Change
Certificates	+ Add	✎ Change

Recent actions

My actions

None available

Users and roles

Everyone has a user account, one role and one or more access areas. The role decides what they can change; the access areas decide which optional modules they can open. Anyone with a role can see the core of PHAEMA (properties, leases, events, cases and documents), run reports and download lists.

	Administrator	Surveyor	Contributor	Viewer
Start and work on cases	All	Own, or on properties they manage	No	No
Add notes, documents and emails to cases	All	As above	Cases they are added to	No
See confidential case notes	Yes	Cases they own	No	No
Change properties	All	Those they manage	No	No
Change leases, rents, breaks and events	All	On properties they manage	No	No
Change parties	Yes	Yes	No	No
Titles, boundaries, settings, imports, users	Yes	No	No	No

To add a user: **Manage data**, **Users**, **Add user**. Set a username and starting password, then add their name and email (used for reminders) and choose one group: Administrators, Surveyors, Contributors or Viewers. To stop someone using PHAEMA, untick **Active** rather than deleting them, so their name stays on the records they changed. Hand their open work to colleagues first (see Handing over work, below), which can also switch off their sign-in in the same step.

Forgotten passwords. People reset their own password from **Forgotten your password?** on the sign-in page. PHAEMA emails a link, valid once and for one hour, to the address on their account, so each person needs a correct email address and PHAEMA needs its email service set up. The page never says whether an account was found, closed accounts are sent nothing, and a reset does not switch off two-step sign-in. Where PHAEMA cannot send email, the page tells the person to ask an administrator: set a new password for them in **Manage data**, **Users**.

People can sign in with their email address or their username. Give each person their own email address: if two accounts share one address, neither can sign in with it and both must use their usernames.

Two-step sign-in

Under **Manage data**, **Module settings**, choose who must use two-step sign-in: **administrators** (the default), **everyone**, or nobody (optional). Anyone can turn it on for their own account. The users list shows who has it. If someone loses their phone and their recovery codes, select them in the users list and choose **Reset two-step sign-in**; they set it up again at their next sign-in. It is never required on a public test site.

Single sign-on

People can sign in with their council account through Microsoft 365 (Entra ID) or another OpenID Connect service. Your IT team and the installer set it up first, following the single sign-on guide in the technical manual. Then, under **Manage data**, **Module settings**, **Single sign-on**:

Setting	What it does
Sign in with the council's own accounts	Shows the button on the sign-in page. People are matched to their PHAEMA account by email address the first time they use it, so check each account has the person's work email address
Who can still sign in with a PHAEMA password	Only people without a council account, and administrators as a fallback (the default): once someone has used the button, their PHAEMA password stops working. Or anyone: both work. Administrators and the superuser can always use a PHAEMA password, in case the council's sign-in service is unavailable
Create a PHAEMA account at first council sign-in	Off: only people you have added can sign in. On: anyone the council's service lets through gets an account, but sees nothing until they have a role

Roles from groups. Under **Manage data**, **Sign-in group mappings**, give everyone in one of the council's groups a role, an access area or both. PHAEMA applies this each time a person signs in: they gain what their groups give, and lose what groups they have left gave. Roles and access areas that no mapping mentions stay as you set them. Changes are in the change log.

Leavers. When IT closes a person's council account they can no longer sign in. Someone already signed in stays so until their session ends, so still use **Hand over work** to stop access at once and move their work. Close outside consultants' accounts in PHAEMA yourself when their work ends.

Unlinking. To connect a person to a different council account, open them in **Manage data**, **Users**, tick **Delete** in the **Council sign-in** box and save.

Test account requests

On a public test site, people ask for a sign-in from the sign-in page. Each request appears under **Manage data**, **Test account requests**. Select it and choose **Approve as surveyor**, **Approve as administrator** or **Approve as viewer**. PHAEMA creates the sign-in and emails the person their username and a one-time link to choose a password.

Portfolios

Manage data, **Portfolios** holds the list of portfolios a property can belong to. PHAEMA starts with twenty typical of a large council. Add, rename or reorder them, and untick **Active** to retire one without losing it from existing properties.

Supervisors

Each surveyor needs a **supervisor and approver**, set on their user record under **Staff details**, with a job title. The supervisor can be a surveyor or an administrator, but nobody approves their own work. The dashboard warns administrators about any surveyor without one.

Access areas

Access areas are named groups that open the optional modules. A person can be in several. Administrators can always open everything the council has switched on.

Area	Opens	Typical people
Estates	Rent, arrears and service charges for their own patch	Surveyors, Head of Estates
Finance	Rent ledger, service charges and asset valuation, plus maintenance to read. Surveyors in Finance can raise rent, credit notes and finance exports, approve service charge budgets and import receipts	Finance officers
Maintenance and compliance	Maintenance and compliance	Building and facilities staff

Area	Opens	Typical people
Valuation	Asset valuation	Internal valuers
Legal	The core only; contributors work on the cases they are added to	The legal team

Tick a person's areas on their user record, under **Access areas**. Change what an area opens under **Manage data**, **Access areas**. When access areas arrived, everyone was put in all five; narrow each person's access from there.

PHAEMA refuses a module someone's areas do not include, even if they type its address, and tells them to ask an administrator. Menus, dashboards, reports, the change log, Hand over work and works order approvals follow the same rules.

Their own patch. People in Estates see rent, arrears and service charges for the properties they manage, those of everyone below them in the supervision chain (the whole chain, so a director sees the Head of Estates' team as well), and anyone they are covering for. A lease over several properties appears for every surveyor whose patch includes one of them. Properties with no managing surveyor appear only to Finance and administrators.

Finance officers need the Surveyor role and the Finance area to raise rent and issue credit notes; they do not need to be administrators. Someone with the Viewer role in Finance can see the ledger but not change it.

Cover for absence

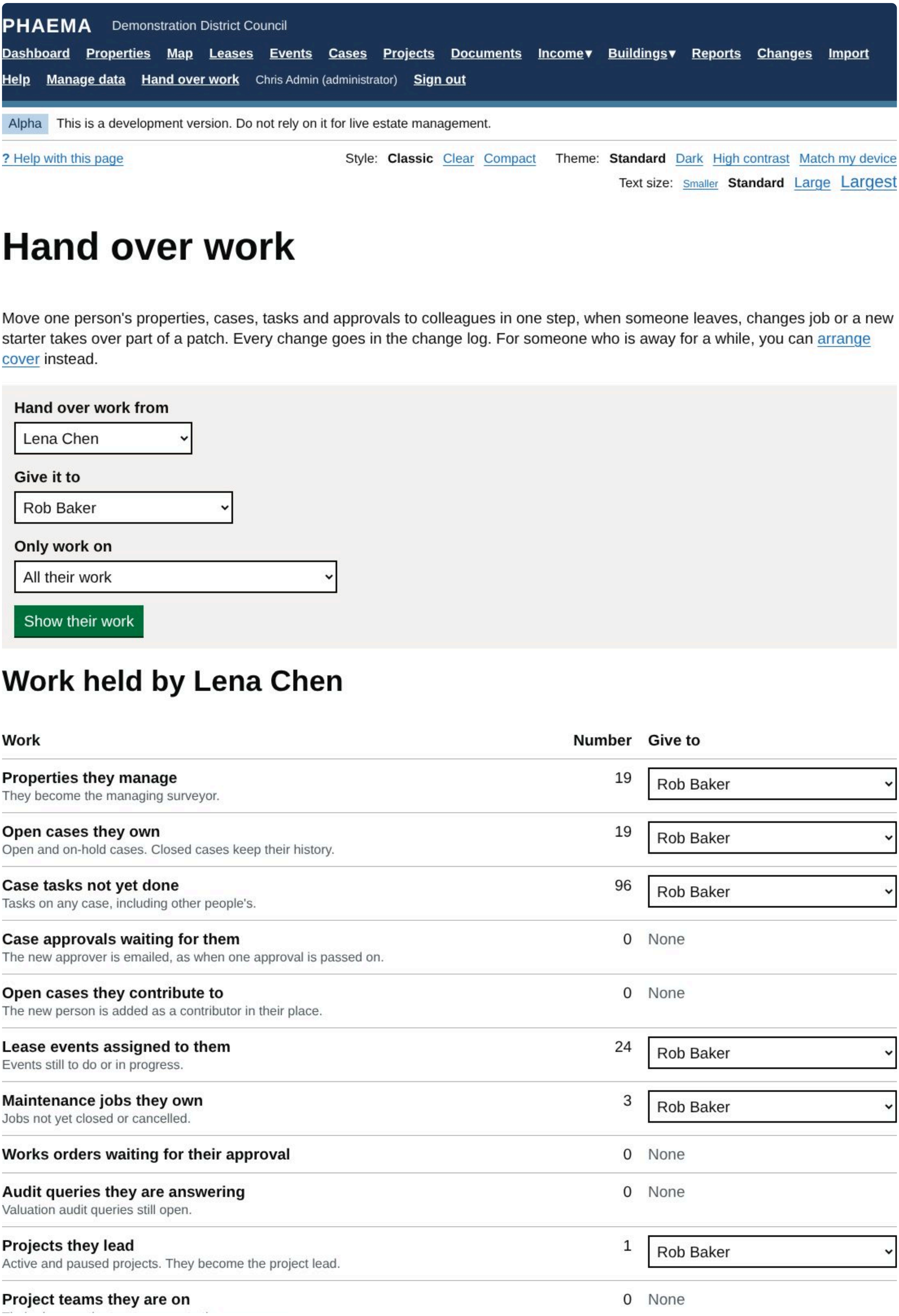
While someone is away, a colleague can cover their patch. Administrators can arrange cover for anyone, and supervisors for anyone in their chain: select **Arrange cover for absence** on My work. Choose who is away, who is covering, and the first and last days. The person covering sees the absent person's patch as their own until the end of the last day, then it stops by itself. **End now** stops it early and **Cancel** removes cover that has not started. Cover and area changes appear in the change log.

Worked example. Lena Chen is on leave for a fortnight. Her supervisor, Sam Hughes, arranges cover by Rob Baker until the day before she returns. Rob can now open Lena's tenants' rent accounts and arrears, and loses that access automatically when the cover ends. To move work for good instead, use Hand over work.

Handing over work

When someone leaves, changes job, or a new starter takes over part of a patch, an administrator moves their open work to colleagues in one step with **Hand over work**. Select it in the menu (it is also linked from the Role section of each user record), or go to

`/people/hand-over/`.



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Help
Manage data
Hand over work
Chris Admin (administrator)
Sign out
Alpha
This is a development version. Do not rely on it for live estate management.
? Help with this page
Style: Classic Clear Compact
Theme: Standard Dark High contrast Match my device
Text size: Smaller Standard Large Largest

Hand over work

Move one person's properties, cases, tasks and approvals to colleagues in one step, when someone leaves, changes job or a new starter takes over part of a patch. Every change goes in the change log. For someone who is away for a while, you can arrange cover instead.

Hand over work from: Lena Chen

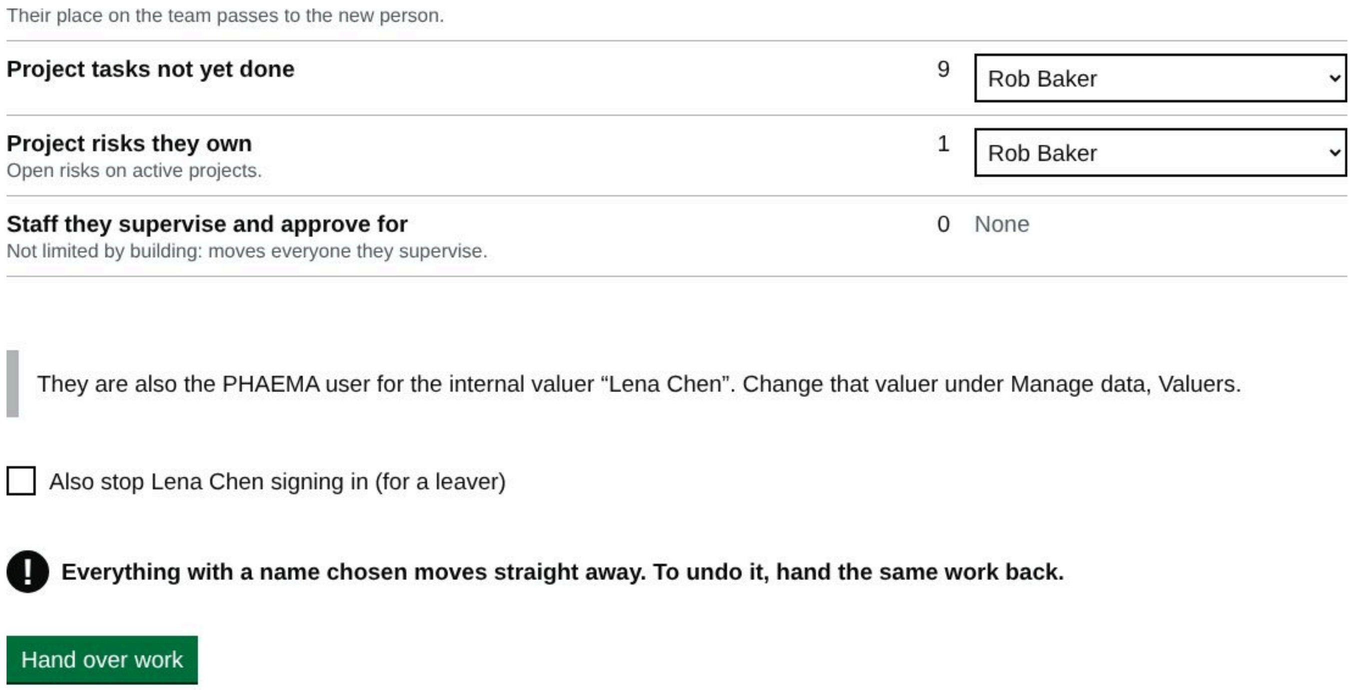
Give it to: Rob Baker

Only work on: All their work

Show their work

Work held by Lena Chen

Work	Number	Give to
Properties they manage They become the managing surveyor.	19	Rob Baker
Open cases they own Open and on-hold cases. Closed cases keep their history.	19	Rob Baker
Case tasks not yet done Tasks on any case, including other people's.	96	Rob Baker
Case approvals waiting for them The new approver is emailed, as when one approval is passed on.	0	None
Open cases they contribute to The new person is added as a contributor in their place.	0	None
Lease events assigned to them Events still to do or in progress.	24	Rob Baker
Maintenance jobs they own Jobs not yet closed or cancelled.	3	Rob Baker
Works orders waiting for their approval	0	None
Audit queries they are answering Valuation audit queries still open.	0	None
Projects they lead Active and paused projects. They become the project lead.	1	Rob Baker
Project teams they are on	0	None



Their place on the team passes to the new person.

Project tasks not yet done	9	Rob Baker
Project risks they own Open risks on active projects.	1	Rob Baker
Staff they supervise and approve for Not limited by building: moves everyone they supervise.	0	None

> They are also the PHAEMA user for the internal valuer “Lena Chen”. Change that valuer under Manage data, Valuers.

☐ Also stop Lena Chen signing in (for a leaver)

Everything with a name chosen moves straight away. To undo it, hand the same work back.

1. Choose **Hand over work from** and **Give it to.** To hand over only part of a patch, choose one estate, site or building under **Only work on**.
2. Select **Show their work.** PHAEMA counts what they hold.
3. For each kind of work, keep the person you chose, pick someone else, or choose **Leave with** to keep it where it is.
4. For a leaver, tick **Also stop them signing in**. Then select **Hand over work**.

Work	What moves
Properties they manage	The new person becomes the managing surveyor
Open cases they own	Open and on-hold cases; closed cases keep the original owner
Case tasks not yet done	Their tasks on any open case
Case approvals waiting for them	The new approver is emailed
Open cases they contribute to	The new person is added as a contributor in their place
Lease events assigned to them	Events still to do or in progress
Maintenance jobs they own	Jobs not yet closed or cancelled
Works orders waiting for their approval	Pending approvals only
Audit queries they are answering	Open valuation audit queries

Work	What moves
Projects they lead	Active and paused projects; the new person becomes the lead
Project teams they are on	Their place on the team passes to the new person (dropped if they are already on it)
Project tasks and risks	Open tasks and open risks on active and paused projects
Staff they supervise	Everyone they supervise (not limited by building)

Work can only go to active surveyors and administrators; contributors can also take over case contributions. Every record moved appears in the change log under the administrator's name. There is no undo button: hand the same work back to reverse it. If the person is also an internal valuer, change the valuer record under **Manage data**, **Valuers**.

Worked example. Lena Chen holds 19 properties, 19 open cases, 96 case tasks, 24 lease events and 3 maintenance jobs in the demonstration data. Choosing Rob Baker under **Give it to** fills every row with his name; selecting **Hand over work** moves it all, and the change log lists each record.

Council settings

Under **Manage data**, **Module settings**:

Setting	What it does
Organisation name and brand colour	Shown in the header
Modules	Rent ledger, service charges, maintenance, compliance, asset valuation. Data is kept when a module is switched off
Letters and notices	Department, address for service, phone and email on letters
Publish open data	Publishes the Transparency Code list and available property
Works orders needing approval	The approval limit for works orders
OS Maps API key	Turns on Ordnance Survey base maps

Setting	What it does
Reminder timings	Days before each kind of event to send reminders, and weekly overdue reminders
Rent ledger settings	Who raises invoices, invoice numbering, VAT rate and codes, income codes

Case types set each type's targets, tasks, fee and which stages need approval. Asset classes, valuers, compliance types, cost headings and document templates are also under **Manage data**.

Site visit sheets. Each case type has its own site visit sheet, changed on the case type's page (or select **Change this sheet for all cases of this type** on any sheet). Under **Property information on the site visit sheet**, tick the parts of the property record to print: key facts, location, description and construction, services, parking, floor areas, floor plans, titles, the tenancy summary, the main terms of each agreement, and other open cases. The case details and **Before you visit** are always printed. Under **Site visit checklist**, add, reword, reorder or remove items:

Setting	What it does
Order	Items are printed lowest first
Heading	Items with the same heading are printed together, such as Outside or Inside
Item	What to check or record
Guidance	A short prompt printed under the item
Answer	Tick when checked, yes or no, a written answer, a number or measurement, or one of a list
List to choose from	For "one of a list": the choices, separated by commas, such as Good, Fair, Poor, Bad
Checks the recorded	A detail of the property record to print beside the item: occupation, use, description, when built, construction, storeys, roof, windows, parking, services, solar panels, floor areas, site area or site hazards
For each building	On a site with several buildings, repeat the item under each one

PHAEMA comes with starting checklists for valuations, lease events, consents, dilapidations and breaches, and land enquiries. They are a starting point: review them against your own inspection standards. Case types that do not involve a visit, such as arrears, have none, and a case type you add yourself starts without one. Your changes are kept when PHAEMA is updated.

Data and hosting

PHAEMA is designed to be hosted in the UK or EU, by the council or a provider. The data belongs to the council. Photos have their location data removed, and documents can only be opened by signed-in users.

16. Quick reference by role

Estates surveyor

To	Go to
See what needs doing today	Dashboard, My work, Needs attention now
Record a rent review	Events, the review, Record the outcome
Start a consent case	The agreement, Start a case
Ask for approval	The case, Conflicts of interest, then Ask for approval
Fill in heads of terms	The new letting or renewal case, Heads of terms
Record a section 25 or 26 notice	The renewal case, Record a notice
Write a letter or notice	The case, Create a letter or notice
File an email on a case	The case, File an email
Get my events in Outlook	Events, Calendar
Start a project	Projects, Start a project
Record a gateway decision	The project page, Gateways, Record gateway
Finish a project's register changes	The project page, Completion checklist

Finance officer

To	Go to
Raise the quarter's rent	Income, Rents, Raise rent
Import receipts	Income, Rents, Import receipts
See arrears	Income, Rents, Arrears
Credit a charge	The tenant's rent account, Credit this charge
Send charges to finance	Income, Rents, Finance exports
Approve a service charge budget	Income, Service charges, the year, Approve the budget
Reconcile a service charge year	The year, Reconcile the year
Accept a valuation	Buildings, Asset valuation, the valuation, Accept
Answer an audit query	The valuation, Record the response sent to the auditor
Year-end schedule	Buildings, Asset valuation, Year-end schedule for finance

Maintenance and compliance

To	Go to
Report a repair	Buildings, Maintenance, Report a repair
Issue a works order	The job, Contractor, estimate and order number, Issue the works order
Approve an order	Dashboard, works orders waiting for your approval
Recharge a tenant	The completed job, Recharge the cost
Add statutory tasks	The property's maintenance page, Add tasks from the library
Record a certificate	The property's compliance page, Record a certificate
Screen a building's tier	The property's compliance page, Screen this building

To	Go to
Add a new version of a plan	The property's compliance page, Add a document or a new version

System administrator

To	Go to
Add a user and role	Manage data, Users, Add user
Set a supervisor	The user record, Staff details
Hand over a leaver's work	The user record, Hand over work
Switch a module on	Manage data, Module settings
Change approval stages	Manage data, Case types
Import properties or leases	Import
Reassign a waiting approval	The case, Send to someone else
See who changed something	Changes

Viewer and contributor

To	Go to
Find a property	Properties, search
Download a list	Download Excel above any list
Run a report	Reports
Add to a case (contributors)	The case, Add a note, File an email or Add a document

17. Glossary

Term	Meaning
1954 Act	The Landlord and Tenant Act 1954, Part II. Business tenants inside the Act have a right to renew; a lease can be contracted out by a set procedure before it is granted
Agreement for lease	A contract to grant a lease in the future
Apportionment	Charging part of a period's rent by the day when an agreement starts or ends part way through
Arrears	Rent overdue: the due date has passed and it has not been paid or credited
Break option	A right to end a lease early on a set date, usually by notice by a deadline
CIPFA Code	The Code of Practice on Local Authority Accounting, which sets how assets are valued in the accounts
DRC	Depreciated replacement cost, used to value specialised buildings
EPC and DEC	Energy Performance Certificate, and Display Energy Certificate for public buildings
Fair value level	The IFRS 13 hierarchy (1, 2 or 3) showing how observable a valuation's inputs are
FRI	Full repairing and insuring: the tenant pays for all repairs and insurance
GIA and NIA	Gross internal area (inside the external walls) and net internal area (usable space)
Gateway	A decision point between a project's phases, such as approval to proceed by Cabinet. A project moves on only when the decision is recorded.
Golden Thread	Accurate, up-to-date building information; statutory for higher-risk buildings
Holding over	A tenant staying after the term end, often while a renewal is agreed

Term	Meaning
INSPIRE Index Polygons	HM Land Registry's free boundaries of registered freehold titles
Licence	Permission to use property without a lease or security of tenure
MEES	Minimum energy efficiency standards: no new lettings below EPC band E without an exemption
Option to tax	A landlord's choice to charge VAT on commercial rent
Peppercorn rent	A nominal rent, often nothing at all
Prescribed form	A notice whose wording is set by law and must be used
Project	A larger piece of work than a case, such as a development, acquisition or disposal, with a team, gateways, milestones, a budget and risks.
Quarter days	25 March, 24 June, 29 September and 25 December
Red Book	RICS Valuation – Global Standards
Rent review	A point where the rent is reassessed; upwards only means it cannot fall
Rent roll	Total rent receivable from current lettings
Service charge	A tenant's share of shared costs, paid on account and balanced after the year end
Terrier	A council's register of the land and property it owns
UPRN and USRN	National identifiers for every addressable place and every street
Void share	The service charge share of empty units, paid by the landlord
WAULT	Weighted average unexpired lease term, weighted by rent
Wayleave	Permission, usually paid, for a utility to run cables or pipes across land